

The Architecture of *Grace*

Book 1 · The Foundation

*A Complete Year-Long SEL Curriculum in Forgiveness, Grace, and
Self-Compassion*

GRADES K · 1 · 2 · TEACHER MASTER EDITION

SECULAR · RESEARCH-GROUNDED · TRAUMA-INFORMED · CASEL-ALIGNED

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BOOK ONE

The Foundation

Teacher Master Edition

Secular · Research-Grounded · Trauma-Informed · CASEL-Aligned
Tier 1 Universal SEL · 28 Lessons across 4 Units
CONFIDENTIAL · FOR DISTRICT REVIEW AND EDUCATOR USE ONLY

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SECTION ONE

TEACHER LAUNCH PACK

Daily-Use Materials · Read Before Lesson 1

1.1 How to Use This Master Document

This document is your single source of truth for delivering Architecture of Grace, Book 1: The Foundation, to Grades K–2. Everything you need — lesson scripts, Sammy puppet guides, anchor charts, drawing activities, scenario cards, safety protocols, assessment tools, and family communications — is in one place, organized so that the materials you use daily are at the front, and the materials you reference occasionally are at the back.

Each anchor chart appears immediately after its lesson as a full print-and-post page. Drawing activities and scenario cards follow the lessons that use them.

WHAT IS IN EVERY LESSON

Opening Review — a 1–2 minute structured bridge from the previous lesson activating prior knowledge. Every lesson except L1.

Sammy Puppet Script — exact words for the Kind Coach voice. Practice both Kind Coach and Grumpy Gus voices before Lesson 1.

Anchor Chart — built WITH students on the day indicated. Print-and-post page follows each lesson. Keep posted all year.

Drawing Activity — informal, teacher-directed. Visual example of finished work included as Teacher Reference.

Exit Ticket & Teacher Reflection — closing formative check and private teacher prompt at every lesson.

Safety Check — pre-lesson checklist, in-lesson scans, post-lesson close-out. Complete before delivering risk-flagged lessons.

GRADE-BAND NOTE · GRADES K-2

The Foundation uses Sammy the puppet as the voice of curriculum content. Sammy holds two voices: Kind Coach (warm, gentle) and Grumpy Gus (sharper, theatrical, never frightening). Practice both voices before Lesson 1. Every lesson begins with Sammy in the same physical spot. The classroom learns to anticipate Sammy as a regular presence — a relational anchor for vulnerable conversations. This consistency is not optional. **This ritual is not optional.** It is the threshold between the social world of school and the interior work of this class.

1.2 Color & Icon Key

Each visual cue in this curriculum has a consistent meaning. Read this key once and return to it as needed.

Opening Review	TEAL	1–2 minute structured bridge activating prior knowledge from the last lesson.
Sammy Puppet Script	PURPLE	Exact scripted voice for Kind Coach and Grumpy Gus. Italicized in the lessons.
Anchor Chart	TEAL	Built WITH students on the day indicated. Full-page printable follows each lesson. Keep posted all year.
Drawing Activity	GOLD	Informal, teacher-directed art activity. A polished visual example follows the lesson.
Scenario Cards	PURPLE	Two cards per lesson. Print, cut vertically, and laminate. Reuse year over year.
Exit Ticket & Reflection	GREEN	Closing formative check and private teacher prompt. Every lesson.
In-Lesson Scan	AMBER	Inline at the specific activity it monitors. Watch for named behaviors. Note privately.
Safety Check	RED	Pre-lesson checklist. Complete before delivering any risk-flagged lesson. Non-negotiable.
★★ Highest Risk	RED	Counselor must be physically on-site the full lesson. No exceptions. No substitutes.
★ Elevated Risk	AMBER	Counselor on-site or co-facilitating. Minimum one week advance notice.
PPRA-Designated	PURPLE	Parental notification required. All standard opt-out protocols apply. See Section 4.

1.3 Safety Protocols — Quick Reference

Read before Lesson 1. Return before every risk-flagged lesson.

★★ HIGHEST RISK

COUNSELOR PHYSICALLY ON-SITE · FULL LESSON · NO EXCEPTIONS U2 L6 · When It's Hard to Forgive Yourself U3 L3 · Forgiving Is Not the Same as Trusting

★ ELEVATED RISK

COUNSELOR ON-SITE OR CO-FACILITATING · ONE-WEEK ADVANCE NOTICE U2 L4 · Being Kind to Myself — Counselor briefed U2 L5 · Letting Go — The Practice — Counselor briefed U3 L5 · My Story Is Not the Whole Me — Counselor on-site U4 L7 · Year-End Celebration — Counselor on standby

DISCLOSURE PROTOCOL · APPLIES TO ALL LESSONS

1. STOP the lesson immediately. 2. Activate your school's mandatory disclosure protocol. 3. Contact the counselor now — not after class. Not after the lesson. Now. **4. Do NOT leave the student alone.** 5. Do not attempt to assess risk yourself. 6. Document in writing the same day. See **Section 4 — Legal & Clinical Compliance** — for the complete student disclosure protocol.

CRISIS RESOURCES · POST BEFORE U2 L6

988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline · Call or text **988 Crisis Text Line** · Text **HOME** to **741741**

1.4 Year-at-a-Glance Pacing Calendar

Each unit unfolds over roughly two months and contains seven lessons. Plan your counselor coordination dates before Unit 1 Lesson 1.

Knowing & Accepting Yourself Aug – Oct · 7 Lessons

Self-Compassion & Self-Forgiveness Oct – Dec · 7 Lessons

Empathy & Forgiving Others Jan – Mar · 7 Lessons

Grace & Generosity Apr – Jun · 7 Lessons

COUNSELOR COORDINATION REQUIRED

CRITICAL: Block ALL counselor-required lesson dates BEFORE Unit 1 Lesson 1. U2 L4 ★ · U2 L5 ★ · U2 L6 ★★ · U3 L3 ★★ · U3 L5 ★ · U4 L7** ★

1.5 Year-Start Classroom Introduction — The Sammy Ritual

Conduct this ritual on Day 1 of the school year. Before any curriculum content. Before any expectation-setting. Before anything else.

SAMMY · KIND COACH VOICE

"Hi. My name is Sammy. I'm going to be with your class all year. I have a lot to learn — just like you. Can you say hi to me?"

Sammy passes through the room and offers a small wave or nod to each student by name. The teacher reads the next passage in their own voice — not Sammy's:

"Once a week, for about 20 minutes, Sammy and I are going to work on something with you. Not reading, not math — something about the inside of your life. How you feel. What to do when things go wrong. How to be kind — to yourself and to other people. You never have to share more than you want to."

After the introduction, Sammy is placed in the same physical spot for the rest of the year. Students will come to recognize that spot as the place where the work of this curriculum happens. Do not move Sammy. Do not put Sammy away between lessons.

TEACHING TIP

Two voices, one puppet. Practice both Kind Coach and Grumpy Gus before Lesson 1. Kind Coach is warm and gentle. Grumpy Gus is sharper, slightly theatrical, never frightening. Children will learn to recognize the difference — and that recognition is half the curriculum.

1.6 Classroom Compact Guide

Co-create with students at the end of **Unit 1 Lesson 1**. Post permanently — this is the relational contract for the full year.

GRADE-BAND NOTE · GRADES K-2

Why co-creation matters at K-2. Young children are exquisitely sensitive to authenticity. A list of rules the teacher has already written communicates that this is something done to them, not with them. When students help write the compact — even one word at a time — they own it. The act of co-creation is itself the first lesson in agency.

PROTOCOL · FOUR STEPS

Step 1 · Frame it before you start (1-2 min): Say in plain words: "We are about to make a list of how we want this room to feel — so it's safe to talk about real things. We will make it together."

Step 2 · Generate (4-6 min): Hold up Sammy. Ask: "What do we need to feel safe in this space?" Take 4-5 short answers from students. Write each one on chart paper exactly as offered. Do not paraphrase or edit.

Step 3 • Add the four foundation lines (3–4 min): After student answers are captured, say: “I want to add four lines we always include in this curriculum.” Read them aloud and add them to the chart.

Step 4 • The signing ritual (2–3 min): Read the whole compact aloud. Each student adds a small mark or initials to the bottom of the chart — a visible, public signature. The teacher signs last. Post permanently.

FOUR LINES THAT MUST ALWAYS BE INCLUDED

1 • WHAT IS SHARED HERE STAYS HERE.

Visual: a lock with a heart.

2 • YOU NEVER HAVE TO SHARE MORE THAN YOU CHOOSE.

Visual: a hand with a stop sign.

3 • FEELINGS ARE OKAY — ALL OF THEM.

Visual: a row of emoji faces.

4 • KIND COACH VOICES ONLY — WITH EACH OTHER AND WITH OURSELVES.

Visual: Sammy with a speech bubble.

✓ SECTION CHECKPOINT

Section 1 — Teacher Launch Pack — complete. You are ready for Lesson 1. Save this section before continuing into Section 2.



SECTION TWO

THE LESSONS

28 Lessons · 4 Units · K–2

UNIT 1



Knowing & Accepting Yourself

Who Am I?

20–25 min · Week 1 · First Lesson of the Year

OBJECTIVE	Students name at least two things about themselves and understand every person in the class is unique.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness · identifying personal qualities and positive self-concept
VOCABULARY	who I am · special · unique · strength · different
MATERIALS	Drawing paper · crayons · large identity web poster · Sammy puppet

SAFETY CHECK

Before class: Confirm Sammy is in his permanent spot. Practice the Kind Coach voice once. This is the first lesson — the tone you set today shapes the rest of the year.

SAMMY · KIND COACH VOICE

"I want to know all about YOU! Can you tell me one thing that makes you special?"

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 5

1

Introduce Sammy

3 MIN

Take two minutes to introduce Sammy before any content. Let students meet the puppet and feel the tone. Sammy says hello to each student by name. The classroom learns to anticipate Sammy as a regular presence.

IN-LESSON SCAN

After Sammy greetings: scan the room. Any child who did not respond may need a gentle individual check-in. Note for Teacher Reflection — do not address publicly.

2

Build the Identity Web

7 MIN

Draw a large web on the board — centre circle says "ME." Five branches: Things I Love · Things I'm Good At · Things That Make Me Happy · Something Special About My Family · Something People Might Not Know About Me. Build one branch at a time. Model with your own answers first.

3

Individual Webs

8 MIN

Students draw their own mini identity web on paper. Circulate with warmth — every web is valid, every answer is right.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1 · THE FOUNDATION (K-2)

IN-LESSON SCAN

While circulating: any student staring at blank paper for more than 2 minutes — crouch down: "Tell me one thing you love, I'll write it for you." Do not press publicly.

4

Share Circle

5 MIN

Each student holds up their paper and shares ONE thing of their choosing. They never have to share more than they want to. Sammy responds warmly to each share.

5

Establish the Compact

2 MIN

After the share circle: begin the Classroom Compact. "What do we need to feel safe in this space?" Collect 3–5 answers, post permanently. See Section 1.6 for the full Compact protocol.

KINDERGARTEN

GRADES 1–2

EXIT TICKET

"Thumb up if you feel like the class knows one true thing about you today." Sammy: thumbs-up to every hand. No commentary. Sammy validates participation, not content.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Which students struggled to name anything — defaulting to silence? This is early data about self-perception that will matter all year. Note quietly.

SAFETY CHECK

POST-LESSON CLOSE-OUT · Any child who did not engage at all — flag for a gentle individual check-in before Lesson 2. **Did anything arise today requiring counselor follow-up?** ☐ No ☐ Yes — contact counselor today

FAMILY CONNECTION

Today we began the year by celebrating who your child is. Ask at home: "What is one thing you would put on YOUR identity web?" Listen without correcting. Every answer is right.

ANCHOR CHART · UNIT 1 · LESSON 1

Print this page · Laminate for durability · Post in classroom · Keep posted all year

DRAWING ACTIVITY · UNIT 1 · LESSON 1

Teacher reference · Print and post during the activity

SCENARIO CARDS · UNIT 1 · LESSON 1

Print — Cut vertically · Laminate · Reuse year after year

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1 · THE FOUNDATION (K-2)
DRAWING EXAMPLE · UNIT 1 · LESSON 1

Visual reference for the drawing activity

My Feelings Are Friends

20–25 min · Week 2

OBJECTIVE	Students identify and name at least four basic emotions and understand that all feelings are okay — every feeling carries a message.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness · recognising and naming emotions
VOCABULARY	happy · sad · angry · scared · proud · worried · feelings are messengers
MATERIALS	Feeling face cards · Sammy puppet · feelings anchor chart paper · open floor space

OPENING REVIEW · 1–2 MIN

Show the identity web from Lesson 1. "Last lesson we learned we are all special. Today Sammy has a question for us." Sammy holds up a worried face: "Is it okay to feel sad? What about angry?" Take 2–3 student responses.

SAMMY · KIND COACH VOICE

"I am feeling something right now. Can you help me figure out what I am feeling?"

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 5

1 Name the Feelings 5 MIN

Hold up feeling face cards one by one. As each is named, Sammy mirrors the face. "Sammy is feeling SAD. What might be happening for Sammy?" Take 2–3 short answers per feeling. Do not rush.

IN-LESSON SCAN

Watch for any child who physically mimics Sammy's distressed pose and does not come out of it. These children may be showing you something real. Note privately.

2 Feelings Are Messengers 4 MIN

Deliver the core teaching: "Feelings are not problems. Every feeling has a message. Sad means something we love is hurt. Angry means something feels unfair. Scared means something feels unsafe. Feelings help us know what we need."

3 Body Movement — Show Me 5 MIN

Move to open floor space. Teacher calls out feelings; students show the feeling with their whole body — face, posture, hands. "Show me proud." "Show me worried." "Show me brave." End with "show me calm."

UNIT 1 · LESSON 2 · THE FOUNDATION (K-2)

IN-LESSON SCAN

During movement: any child frozen, covering face, or refusing to participate may be experiencing something real. Do not press. Note for reflection.

4

Build the Anchor Chart

7 MIN

Build the Feelings Anchor Chart together. As students name each feeling, Sammy adds the face and one short message. The chart becomes the permanent reference for the year.

5

Closing Question

2 MIN

Sammy asks: "What is the most important thing about feelings?" Sample from class. Land on: "All feelings are okay. They tell us something."

KINDERGARTEN

GRADES 1-2

EXIT TICKET

"Show me on your face: one feeling you felt today. Sammy mirrors the emotion back to the child." Sammy: thumbs-up to every hand. No commentary. Sammy validates participation, not content.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Which students showed the broadest emotional vocabulary? Which could only name "happy" or "mad"? Note for differentiated support.

SAFETY CHECK

POST-LESSON CLOSE-OUT · Any child who became unusually distressed during the movement activity — note for a brief individual check-in before Lesson 3. **Did anything arise today requiring counselor follow-up?** ☐ No ☐ Yes — contact counselor today

FAMILY CONNECTION

Today we learned that feelings are messengers — not problems. Try this at home: when a big feeling comes up, ask "What is this feeling trying to tell us?" rather than trying to fix it right away.

ANCHOR CHART · UNIT 1 · LESSON 2

Print this page · Laminate for durability · Post in classroom · Keep posted all year

SCENARIO CARDS · UNIT 1 · LESSON 2

Print · Cut vertically · Laminate · Reuse year after year

DRAWING EXAMPLE · UNIT 1 · LESSON 2

Visual reference for the drawing activity

Everyone Makes Mistakes

20–25 min · Week 3

OBJECTIVE	Students articulate that mistakes are normal and universal, and that a mistake does not mean they are bad.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness · growth mindset; separating actions from identity
VOCABULARY	mistake · oops · learning · try again · normal · everyone
MATERIALS	Mentor text: Beautiful Oops! by Barney Saltzberg · Sammy puppet · sticky notes · Mistake Wall space

OPENING REVIEW · 1–2 MIN

Show the Feelings Anchor Chart. "Last lesson: feelings are messengers. Today Sammy makes a mistake." Sammy knocks something over dramatically. "Is Sammy bad — or did he just make a mistake?*" "

SAMMY · KIND COACH VOICE

"Wait — did I make a mistake... or AM I a mistake? Are those the same thing?"

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 5

1

Sammy's Question

3 MIN

Deliver the distinction: An Oops is something you DID. "I am bad" is about WHO YOU ARE. They are not the same. "Has anyone here ever made a mistake? Does that mean everyone here is bad?" Wait for the laugh.

Sammy: "I made a mistake. But I am still ME. I am not bad — I just had an Oops!"

2

Read-Aloud · Beautiful Oops!

7 MIN

Read Beautiful Oops! by Barney Saltzberg with enthusiasm. After each page: "What happened? Did that turn out to be a bad thing or something surprising?"

IN-LESSON SCAN

During the read-aloud: watch for children whose body language shifts at the word "mistake." Clenching or looking down can indicate shame at home. Do not address publicly. Note for the Teacher Reflection.

3

Mistake Wall

6 MIN

Distribute sticky notes. Each student draws or dictates ONE mistake. Post on the Mistake Wall. "Look at ALL these mistakes — every one made by the amazing people in this room. Mistakes are NORMAL."

UNIT 1 · LESSON 3 · THE FOUNDATION (K-2)

4

Class Chant

6 MIN

Sammy picks up what was knocked over: "Oops. I made a mistake. I will fix it." Students practise as a chant with body movements: OOPS → FIX IT → TRY AGAIN. Repeat three times with growing energy.

5

Land the Distinction

3 MIN

End with the core line: "A mistake is not who you are — it is something that happened. Oops + Fix It + Try Again = GROWTH. You are a learner, not a failure.**"

KINDERGARTEN

GRADES 1-2

EXIT TICKET

"Raise your hand if you know that making a mistake does not make you bad." Sammy: thumbs-up to every hand. No commentary. Sammy validates participation, not content.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Which students seemed to genuinely believe a mistake means they are bad? Note for Unit 2 — these students will need extra support during the Real Sorry and Self-Compassion lessons.

SAFETY CHECK

POST-LESSON CLOSE-OUT · Review the Mistake Wall. Any note describing something witnessed rather than done warrants a quiet follow-up conversation — not in front of peers. **Did anything arise today requiring counselor follow-up?** ☐ No ☐ Yes — contact counselor today

FAMILY CONNECTION

Today we learned that mistakes are normal — everyone makes them. At home, try sharing one of YOUR recent mistakes (something small). Modelling makes it safe for children to do the same.

ANCHOR CHART · UNIT 1 · LESSON 3

Print this page · Laminate for durability · Post in classroom · Keep posted all year

SCENARIO CARDS · UNIT 1 · LESSON 3

Print · Cut vertically · Laminate · Reuse year after year

DRAWING EXAMPLE · UNIT 1 · LESSON 3

Visual reference for the drawing activity

My Inside Voice — Kind or Unkind?

20–25 min · Week 4

OBJECTIVE	Students identify the difference between a Kind Coach and a Grumpy Gus inner voice, and practise replacing unkind self-talk.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness · recognising self-talk; Self-Management: regulating internal narrative
VOCABULARY	inside voice · Kind Coach · Grumpy Gus · self-talk · kind · unkind
MATERIALS	Sammy puppet (with TWO voices ready) · Kind Coach / Grumpy Gus anchor chart paper · red and green markers

OPENING REVIEW · 1–2 MIN

Show the Mistake Wall. "Last lesson: mistakes are normal. Today: when we make a mistake, what does our inside voice say?" Two student responses.

SAMMY · KIND COACH VOICE

"I have TWO voices that talk inside my head. One is kind. One is grumpy. Today we are going to meet them both."

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 5

1

Meet Kind Coach

4 MIN

Sammy speaks in his Kind Coach voice (warm, gentle): "When I make a mistake, my Kind Coach says — 'Oops! What can I learn? Let's try again.' Kind Coach is honest AND kind. Kind Coach helps me grow.**"

2

Meet Grumpy Gus

4 MIN

Sammy switches to Grumpy Gus voice (sharper, theatrical, never frightening): "Grumpy Gus says — 'You ALWAYS mess up! You're BAD! You'll NEVER get it right!' Grumpy Gus attacks WHO YOU ARE — not just what happened. Grumpy Gus makes us want to hide.**"

3

Sort the Statements

8 MIN

Read 6–8 statements. Class sorts each into Kind Coach (green) or Grumpy Gus (red). Examples: "I made a mistake — I can fix it." (Kind) / "I always ruin everything." (Grumpy) / "What can I learn from this?" (Kind) / "Nobody likes me." (Grumpy). Add to anchor chart as you go.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 4 · THE FOUNDATION (K-2)

IN-LESSON SCAN

During the sort: any child who consistently sides with Grumpy Gus statements ("but they're true though") may be carrying heavy self-talk. Note for follow-up. Do not correct in front of peers.

4

Practice Switching

5 MIN

Teacher reads a Grumpy Gus statement. Class together flips it to Kind Coach. "I always mess up" becomes "I made a mistake — I can try again." Repeat three times with different statements.

5

The Three Questions

3 MIN

Land the closer: "When something goes wrong, the Kind Coach asks three questions. ONE: What happened? TWO: What can I learn? THREE: What is one next step?" Repeat together.

KINDERGARTEN

GRADES 1-2

EXIT TICKET

"Show me with your fingers: how many voices live inside your head? (Hold up two.) Which one are you going to listen to?" Sammy: thumbs-up to every hand. No commentary. Sammy validates participation, not content.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Which students could not generate a Kind Coach reframe? Which seemed surprised the kind voice was even an option? These students need extra support before Unit 2.

SAFETY CHECK

POST-LESSON CLOSE-OUT · Any student whose Grumpy Gus statements felt unusually harsh or specific to their identity — note for counselor awareness. Do not press publicly. **Did anything arise today requiring counselor follow-up?** ☐ No ☐ Yes — contact counselor today

FAMILY CONNECTION

Today we learned about two inside voices: Kind Coach and Grumpy Gus. At home, when you hear your child being hard on themselves, ask gently: "Was that your Kind Coach or your Grumpy Gus?"

ANCHOR CHART · UNIT 1 · LESSON 4

Print this page · Laminate for durability · Post in classroom · Keep posted all year

SCENARIO CARDS · UNIT 1 · LESSON 4

Print · Cut vertically · Laminate · Reuse year after year

DRAWING EXAMPLE · UNIT 1 · LESSON 4

Visual reference for the drawing activity

Oops vs. I Am Bad

20–25 min · Week 5

OBJECTIVE	Students distinguish between an Oops (a behaviour) and "I am bad" (an identity statement), and articulate that the second is never true.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness · separating action from identity (foundational distinction of the curriculum)
VOCABULARY	Oops · behaviour · identity · I AM · I DID · shame · growth
MATERIALS	Sammy puppet · Oops vs. I Am Bad anchor chart · scenario sorting strips

OPENING REVIEW · 1–2 MIN

Show the Kind Coach / Grumpy Gus chart. "Last lesson: two inside voices. Today: when Grumpy Gus talks, sometimes he tries to trick us. He confuses two things that are NOT the same.**"

SAMMY · KIND COACH VOICE

"Grumpy Gus told me two things today. He said 'You made a bad CHOICE.' And he said 'You ARE bad.' Are those the same thing?"

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 5

1

The Big Distinction

4 MIN

Deliver the foundational distinction: "An Oops is about what you DID. 'I am bad' is about who you ARE. One can be fixed. The other is never true — because no one is bad. People do things. People are not their things.**"

2

Two Columns

5 MIN

Build the anchor chart side by side. Left column: OOPS — "What I DID. One moment. Can be fixed. Sounds like: I made a bad CHOICE." Right column: "I AM BAD" — DANGER — "Who I AM. Never true. Sounds like: I am a bad PERSON." Color the danger side red.

3

Sort the Statements

7 MIN

Read scenario strips one at a time. Class decides: Oops or "I Am Bad"? Examples: "I forgot my homework." (Oops) / "I am stupid." (I Am Bad — never true) / "I bumped into someone." (Oops) / "Nobody likes me." (I Am Bad — never true). Discuss why.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 5 · THE FOUNDATION (K-2)

IN-LESSON SCAN

A student who calls "I AM BAD" statements TRUE about themselves — even hypothetically — may be carrying internalised shame. Note for counselor awareness. Do NOT correct publicly.

4

The Test Question

5 MIN

Introduce the lifetime tool: "When Grumpy Gus says something hard, ASK: 'Is this about my BEHAVIOUR or my IDENTITY?' If it's about behaviour — you can fix it. If it's about identity — it's a lie.**"

5

Closing

3 MIN

Sammy: "I will mess up sometimes. That is okay. I will fix it. I will try again. I am NOT my mistakes." Class repeats together as a closing chant.

KINDERGARTEN

GRADES 1-2

EXIT TICKET

"'Is this about my BEHAVIOUR or my IDENTITY?' — say it together with me, three times." Sammy: thumbs-up to every hand. No commentary. Sammy validates participation, not content.

TEACHER REFLECTION

This is the most important distinction in the curriculum. Which students could state it back? Which seemed to genuinely understand "I am not my mistakes"? Which still seemed unsure?

SAFETY CHECK

POST-LESSON CLOSE-OUT · Any student who voiced a strong identity statement about themselves ("I AM bad") — even if they later corrected it — note for counselor awareness. **Did anything arise today requiring counselor follow-up?** ☐ No ☐ Yes — contact counselor today

FAMILY CONNECTION

Today we practised separating what we DID from who we ARE. At home, when redirecting your child, try replacing "you are..." with "what you DID was..." — e.g., not "you are messy" but "what you did was leave the mess."

ANCHOR CHART · UNIT 1 · LESSON 5

Print this page · Laminate for durability · Post in classroom · Keep posted all year

SCENARIO CARDS · UNIT 1 · LESSON 5

Print · Cut vertically · Laminate · Reuse year after year

DRAWING EXAMPLE · UNIT 1 · LESSON 5

Visual reference for the drawing activity

I Can Change and Grow

20–25 min · Week 6

OBJECTIVE	Students articulate that they have grown since the start of the year and identify one specific way they have changed.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness · recognising growth; identifying capacity for change
VOCABULARY	grow · change · before · now · practice · better at · still learning
MATERIALS	Sammy puppet · Then-and-Now drawing paper · crayons · optional photos from start of year

OPENING REVIEW · 1–2 MIN

Show the Mistake Wall and the Oops vs. I Am Bad chart. "We have learned a lot together. Today we are going to look back and see how much we have grown.**"

SAMMY · KIND COACH VOICE

"When I started this year, I did not know how to do a lot of things. Now I can do some of them! I am still learning others. That is what GROWING is."

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 4

1

What Is Growing?

4 MIN

Define growing simply: "Growing means — you can do something now that you could not do before. You learned. You practised. You got better at it. You are still YOU — you just have more skills, more words, more ways to handle hard things.**"

2

Sammy's Story

5 MIN

Sammy shares a small growth story: "When I started this year, I used to say 'I AM bad' when I made a mistake. Now I say 'I made an OOPS — I can fix it.' I am still learning! But I have GROWN."

Sammy: "What is something you used to find hard — that is easier now?"

3

Then-and-Now Drawing

12 MIN

Students fold paper in half. On the BEFORE side: draw something that used to feel hard or scary. On the NOW side: draw the same thing — but with how they handle it now. Optional: add a Kind Coach speech bubble showing what they say to themselves now. See the polished Drawing Activity reference.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 6 · THE FOUNDATION (K-2)

IN-LESSON SCAN

Students who cannot identify any growth may be feeling stuck. Crouch down warmly: "Even noticing one tiny thing counts. Want me to help?" Do not pressure.

4

Share Circle

4 MIN

Voluntary share. Each student who wants to holds up their drawing and describes ONE thing that has changed. Sammy responds warmly to each share. Land: "Growing is small — and real."

KINDERGARTEN

GRADES 1-2

EXIT TICKET

"Hold up your drawing if you found one way you have grown. Sammy bows to each held-up drawing." Sammy: thumbs-up to every hand. No commentary. Sammy validates participation, not content.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Which students struggled to identify any growth? These students may be carrying a fixed sense of self. Pair them with growth-focused responses going forward.

SAFETY CHECK

POST-LESSON CLOSE-OUT · A student whose BEFORE drawing depicts something concerning — a real hurt, an ongoing situation — should be noted for counselor follow-up. **Did anything arise today requiring counselor follow-up?** ☐ No ☐ Yes — contact counselor today

FAMILY CONNECTION

Today we celebrated growth. At home, share with your child one way YOU have grown this year — something you used to find hard that is easier now. Modelling growth makes it visible.

DRAWING ACTIVITY · UNIT 1 · LESSON 6

Teacher reference · Print and post during the activity

Unit 1 Celebration — This Is Me!

25–30 min · Week 7 · Unit 1 Wrap-Up

OBJECTIVE	Students celebrate the work of Unit 1 and articulate one core insight from the unit. The classroom community is reinforced.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness · consolidation; Social Awareness: belonging in community
VOCABULARY	celebrate · community · belonging · proud · together
MATERIALS	Sammy puppet · identity webs (from Lesson 1) · growth drawings (from Lesson 6) · celebration materials · the Mistake Wall (still posted)

OPENING REVIEW · 1–2 MIN

Walk the room together. Stop at the identity webs, the Mistake Wall, the Feelings chart, the Kind Coach chart, the Oops vs. I Am Bad chart. "Look at everything we have built together. Today we celebrate.**"

SAMMY · KIND COACH VOICE

"I have learned so much from your class. You have taught me that I am not my mistakes. You have taught me that all feelings are messengers. You have taught me that we GROW. Thank you."

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 4

- 1 Walk the Year So Far** **7 MIN**
 Visit each anchor chart in turn. At each, ask: "What did we learn here?" Take 1–2 student responses per chart. Land on the through-line: "Every chart in this room is something WE built together."
- 2 My Unit 1 Insight** **8 MIN**
 Each student chooses ONE thing they want to remember from Unit 1. Options: I am unique · All feelings are okay · Mistakes are normal · My Kind Coach helps me · I am not my mistakes · I can grow. Students draw or write their chosen insight on a slip of paper.
- 3 Insight Garland** **6 MIN**
 String all the slips together with yarn or tape into a classroom garland. Hang it where everyone can see. "This is what WE know now — together."
- 4 Bridge to Unit 2** **4 MIN**
 Sammy lays the foundation for Unit 2: "We have learned about ourselves. Next, we will learn what to do when we make a mistake — how to say sorry, how to be kind to ourselves, how to let go. Unit 2 starts next week."

EXIT TICKET

"Touch your hand to your heart and say: "I am ME. I am growing. I am not my mistakes."" Sammy: thumbs-up to every hand. No commentary. Sammy validates participation, not content.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Which students chose insights that mirror their own struggle? (e.g., a student who often hides chooses "All feelings are okay"). These choices reveal what each child needed most. Note for Unit 2 differentiation.

SAFETY CHECK

POST-LESSON CLOSE-OUT · No specific risk this lesson. A general check: any student who appeared disconnected from the celebration may be carrying something unrelated. Note for counselor awareness. **Did anything arise today requiring counselor follow-up?** ☐ No ☐ Yes — contact counselor today

FAMILY CONNECTION

We finished Unit 1 today. Ask your child: "What is one thing you want to remember from Unit 1?" Listen to their answer — it tells you what stuck.

UNIT 2



Self-Compassion & Self-Forgiveness

What Is Forgiveness, Really?

20–25 min · Week 8 · Backpack Demo

OBJECTIVE	Students name what forgiveness is NOT (myth-busting) and what it IS — letting go of angry feelings to free themselves from carrying the weight.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness · recognising emotional load; Self-Management: introduction to release
VOCABULARY	forgiveness · myth · weight · carry · let go · for me — not for them
MATERIALS	Sammy puppet · empty backpack · 4 books or weighted objects · Forgiveness Myth Busters anchor chart

SAFETY CHECK

Some students may have ongoing harmful situations at home or with peers. Forgiveness is NEVER required when someone is still hurting them. If a student shares such a situation, follow the Disclosure Protocol — do not coach them toward forgiveness.

OPENING REVIEW · 1–2 MIN

Show the Unit 1 garland. "Last unit we learned about ourselves. This unit, we learn what to do with the weight we carry inside.**"

SAMMY · KIND COACH VOICE

"Today I am going to bring something to school. It is heavy. Watch."

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 5

1

The Heavy Backpack

4 MIN

Hold up the empty backpack. "This is the inside of us when something hurts. It is light when nothing has gone wrong." Add the first weighted book. "When something hurts — we carry it." Wear the backpack for the rest of the lesson.

2

Myth Buster #1

4 MIN

Hold up the second book. "Some people think forgiveness means FORGETTING what happened. That is a MYTH." Remove the book from the backpack. "Forgiveness does NOT mean forgetting. You can remember and still let go.**"

3 **Myth Buster #2** 4 MIN

Hold up the third book. "Some people think forgiveness means saying it was OKAY. That is a MYTH."
Remove the book. "Forgiveness does NOT mean what happened was okay. You can say 'that was wrong' AND still let go.**"

4 **Myth Buster #3 and #4** 4 MIN

Continue with two more myths: "Forgiveness is NOT weakness — it takes more courage than holding on."
Remove book. "You do NOT have to feel ready before you start — forgiveness is a CHOICE, not a feeling."
Remove final book. The backpack is now empty.

5 **What Forgiveness IS** 5 MIN

Take off the empty backpack. "So what IS forgiveness? Forgiveness is letting go of angry feelings — not to say what happened was okay, but to free YOURSELF from carrying the weight of it. Not for the person who hurt us. For US.**"

KINDERGARTEN

GRADES 1-2

EXIT TICKET

"When you walk out today — feel your back. Is there anything you would like to put down before tomorrow?"
Sammy: thumbs-up to every hand. No commentary. Sammy validates participation, not content.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Which students seemed surprised that forgiveness is NOT about the other person? Which seemed relieved?
Which resisted? Each reaction is meaningful data.

SAFETY CHECK

POST-LESSON CLOSE-OUT · Any student who shared a current harmful situation — follow the Disclosure Protocol immediately. Do NOT coach toward forgiveness when someone is currently being hurt. **Did anything arise today requiring counselor follow-up?** ☐ No ☐ Yes — contact counselor today

FAMILY CONNECTION

Today we learned that forgiveness is NOT forgetting and NOT saying-it-was-okay. It is choosing to let go for our OWN peace. Reinforce at home: forgiveness is a gift you give YOURSELF.

ANCHOR CHART · UNIT 2 · LESSON 1

Print this page · Laminate for durability · Post in classroom · Keep posted all year

SCENARIO CARDS · UNIT 2 · LESSON 1

Print — Cut vertically · Laminate · Reuse year after year

UNIT 2 · LESSON 1 · THE FOUNDATION (K-2)
DRAWING EXAMPLE · UNIT 2 · LESSON 1

Visual reference for the drawing activity

Carrying Too Much

20–25 min · Week 9

OBJECTIVE	Students identify where they carry emotional weight in their bodies and name simple ways to ask for help when feelings get too heavy.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness · somatic awareness; Self-Management: help-seeking
VOCABULARY	heavy · body · tight · busy · drooping · ask for help · safe adult
MATERIALS	Sammy puppet · body outline drawing handouts · crayons · optional colour key

OPENING REVIEW · 1–2 MIN

Show the empty backpack from Lesson 1. "Last lesson: forgiveness is letting go of weight. But where do we FEEL that weight? In our bodies.**"

SAMMY · KIND COACH VOICE

"I am feeling something heavy today. My tummy feels busy. My shoulders feel tight. My body is telling me something. Can your bodies tell you things too?"

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 5

- 1 Body Cues** 4 MIN
 Introduce the idea that bodies carry feelings: "When something is heavy, your body shows it. A busy tummy can mean worry. Tight shoulders can mean stress. A drooping head can mean sad. Bodies are messengers — just like feelings.**"
- 2 Sammy Models** 4 MIN
 Sammy points to different parts of his body. "When I am angry — my hands feel hot. When I am sad — my chest feels heavy. When I am scared — my tummy feels jumpy. Your body might feel different. Both are okay."
- 3 Body Outline Drawing** 10 MIN
 Distribute the body outline handout. "Show me where YOUR body feels things." Students colour or mark the areas that feel tight, heavy, or busy. They can label or leave the marks without words. See the polished Drawing Activity reference for the complete protocol and privacy rules.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2 · THE FOUNDATION (K-2)

IN-LESSON SCAN

Watch for any student who marks the entire body or who hesitates entirely. Do not press. Note privately. A student who cannot mark anything may be disconnected from their body — important data for counselor coordination.

4

Asking for Help

4 MIN

Land the help-seeking message: "When the heavy gets TOO heavy — we tell a safe adult. We do NOT carry it alone. Asking for help is STRONG. Who is one safe adult you can tell?*"

5

Closing

3 MIN

Sammy: "If your body is talking to you and the feeling is too big, you do not have to carry it by yourself. Strong people ask for help."

Sammy: "I am proud of you for listening to your bodies today."

KINDERGARTEN

GRADES 1-2

EXIT TICKET

"My body talks to me" — say it together. Touch the place on YOUR body that talks the most." Sammy: thumbs-up to every hand. No commentary. Sammy validates participation, not content.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Which students could not name a safe adult? This is critical data — these students need a clear named adult identified for them by tomorrow. Coordinate with counselor.

SAFETY CHECK

POST-LESSON CLOSE-OUT · Any student whose body drawing showed widespread heaviness, whose markings concerning specific areas (e.g., excessive marking, distressing symbols), or who could not name a safe helper — flag for counselor today. **Did anything arise today requiring counselor follow-up?** ☐ No ☐ Yes — contact counselor today

FAMILY CONNECTION

Today we noticed how feelings live in our bodies. At home, when your child seems overwhelmed, ask: "What does your body feel like right now?" Naming the body sensation helps the feeling become workable.

DRAWING ACTIVITY · UNIT 2 · LESSON 2

Teacher reference · Print and post during the activity

SCENARIO CARDS · UNIT 2 · LESSON 2

Print · Cut vertically · Laminate · Reuse year after year

Saying Sorry and Meaning It

20–25 min · Week 10 · Co-Construct

OBJECTIVE	Students learn the three parts of a real apology and practise saying sorry in a way that means something.
CASEL FOCUS	Relationship Skills · authentic repair; Self-Management: accountability without self-punishment
VOCABULARY	sorry · apology · real sorry · name what happened · name the hurt · name the change
MATERIALS	Sammy puppet · Three-Part Real Sorry anchor chart paper · scenario practice strips

OPENING REVIEW · 1–2 MIN

Show the body outline drawings from Lesson 2. "Last lesson: feelings live in our bodies. Today: when WE cause the heavy in someone else's body — what do we do?*"

SAMMY · KIND COACH VOICE

"I bumped into someone yesterday and I said sorry really fast. But I do not think they believed me. What makes a sorry REAL?"

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 4

1

A Real Sorry Has Three Parts

5 MIN

Build the framework: "A real sorry has THREE parts. All three matter. Without all three, sorry is a START — not a finish.*"

2

Part One — Name What Happened

4 MIN

Sammy demonstrates: "First — I name what I did. Honestly. NOT vague. 'I bumped into you.' NOT 'I'm sorry IF you got upset.' The real word for the real thing.*"

Sammy: "Part One: I name what I DID."

3

Part Two — Name the Hurt

4 MIN

Continue: "Second — I show I understand how it made the other person feel. 'I know that made you feel worried.' Or 'I know that hurt your feelings.' This is the hardest part. It means really LISTENING.*"

Sammy: "Part Two: I name the HURT."

4

Part Three — Name the Change

7 MIN

Final part: "Third — I make a real promise. 'Next time I will... walk slower / look first / ask before grabbing.' This is the part that says 'I mean it.' Without this part, sorry is just words." Practise together with two scenarios from the scenario card deck.

Sammy: "Part Three: I name the CHANGE."

KINDERGARTEN

GRADES 1-2

EXIT TICKET

"My sorry has three parts" — say it together. Hold up three fingers. One: name what happened. Two: name the hurt. Three: name the change." Sammy: thumbs-up to every hand. No commentary. Sammy validates participation, not content.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Which students struggled with Part Two (naming the hurt)? This part requires perspective-taking and empathy — a key Unit 3 prerequisite. Note for Unit 3 differentiation.

SAFETY CHECK

POST-LESSON CLOSE-OUT · Any student who refused to engage with apology language at all — may be carrying something. Do not press. Note for counselor awareness. **Did anything arise today requiring counselor follow-up?** ☐ No ☐ Yes — contact counselor today

FAMILY CONNECTION

Today we learned that a real sorry has three parts: name what happened, name the hurt, name the change. Try modelling at home: when YOU make a small mistake, deliver all three parts visibly. Children learn what they see.

ANCHOR CHART · UNIT 2 · LESSON 3

Print this page · Laminate for durability · Post in classroom · Keep posted all year

SCENARIO CARDS · UNIT 2 · LESSON 3

Print · Cut vertically · Laminate · Reuse year after year

DRAWING EXAMPLE · UNIT 2 · LESSON 3

Visual reference for the drawing activity

Being Kind to Myself

20–25 min · Week 11 · PPRA · Counselor Briefed

OBJECTIVE	Students articulate that they deserve the same kindness they give a friend, and practise turning kind words inward toward themselves.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Management · self-compassion (adapted from Dr. Kristin Neff's framework)
VOCABULARY	self-compassion · kindness · good friend · common humanity · notice the feeling
MATERIALS	Sammy puppet · Three Parts of Being Kind to Yourself anchor chart · card-fold paper for the kind message

SAFETY CHECK

PPRA-designated lesson. Family notification confirmed. Standard opt-out protocols apply. See Section 4, Legal & Clinical Compliance. Counselor briefed in advance. Counselor on standby — reachable same-day. During the kind-message activity, some students who are heavily critical of themselves may become quietly emotional. This is healthy — they may be receiving permission they have never been given. Do not draw class attention. Acknowledge privately.

OPENING REVIEW · 1–2 MIN

Show the Three-Part Real Sorry chart. "Last lesson: how to apologize to others. Today: a different question. When WE make a mistake — how do we talk to OURSELVES?*"

SAMMY · KIND COACH VOICE

"I have a question that surprised me. If a friend made a mistake — I would be kind to them. But when I make a mistake — I am MEAN to myself. Why?"

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 4

1

The Friend Test

5 MIN

Pose the test: "Imagine your best friend made a mistake. They feel terrible. What would you SAY to them?" Take 3–4 student responses. Write the words on chart paper. Then ask: "Would you say those same words to YOURSELF?*"

2

Part One — Self-Kindness

4 MIN

Build the first part: "When YOU make a mistake — talk to yourself like you would talk to a good friend. 'I care about you. This is hard. You are doing your best.' Speak to yourself with care — not with cruelty.**"

3

Part Two — Common Humanity

4 MIN

Add the second part: "When you make a mistake, remember: EVERYONE goes through hard things. Everyone makes mistakes. Everyone hurts sometimes. You are NOT alone. You are HUMAN.**"

4

Part Three — Mindfulness

5 MIN

The third part: "Notice the feeling. Don't push it away — but don't drown in it. Just NOTICE: 'I am feeling sad right now.' 'I am feeling angry right now.' Naming it makes it smaller." End with the Drawing Activity — see the polished reference for the complete protocol.

Sammy: "I deserve the same kindness I give my friends."

KINDERGARTEN

GRADES 1-2

EXIT TICKET

"Look at your own hand. Make the Sammy thumbs-up. Say to yourself: "I care about you. Everyone goes through hard things. I am noticing this feeling."" Sammy: thumbs-up to every hand. No commentary. Sammy validates participation, not content.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Which students could not generate ANY kind words for themselves — even when prompted with what they would say to a friend? These students need extra support. Note for counselor.

SAFETY CHECK

POST-LESSON CLOSE-OUT · Students who became quietly emotional during the Kind Message activity — likely receiving permission they have never been given. Acknowledge privately. Counselor follow-up if pattern continues. **Did anything arise today requiring counselor follow-up?** ☐ No ☐ Yes — contact counselor today

FAMILY CONNECTION

Today we learned the three parts of being kind to ourselves: self-kindness, common humanity, mindfulness. Adapted from Dr. Kristin Neff's research on self-compassion. At home, model kind self-talk audibly: "I made a mistake — it is okay — I will try again."

ANCHOR CHART · UNIT 2 · LESSON 4

Print this page · Laminate for durability · Post in classroom · Keep posted all year

DRAWING ACTIVITY · UNIT 2 · LESSON 4

Teacher reference · Print and post during the activity

SCENARIO CARDS · UNIT 2 · LESSON 4

Print · Cut vertically · Laminate · Reuse year after year

UNIT 2 · LESSON 4 · THE FOUNDATION (K-2)
DRAWING EXAMPLE · UNIT 2 · LESSON 4

Visual reference for the drawing activity

Letting Go — The Practice

20–25 min · Week 12 · PPRA · Counselor Briefed

OBJECTIVE	Students practise the symbolic act of "putting it down" — releasing one small piece of weight they have been carrying.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Management · symbolic release; emotional regulation
VOCABULARY	put it down · release · practice · again and again · heavy · light
MATERIALS	Sammy puppet · smooth stones (one per student) · small basket or bowl · optional substitute object for tactile-sensitive students

SAFETY CHECK

PPRA-designated lesson. Family notification confirmed. Standard opt-out protocols apply. Counselor briefed in advance. Counselor on standby — reachable same-day. The stone practice may activate students carrying significant weight. They may become quietly emotional. This is the practice working. Do not draw class attention. Acknowledge privately. Substitute object available for tactile-sensitive students (e.g., a small piece of fabric, a folded paper).

OPENING REVIEW · 1–2 MIN

Show the Kind Message cards from Lesson 4. "Last lesson: be kind to yourself. Today: a way to PRACTISE letting go of something heavy.**"

SAMMY · KIND COACH VOICE

"I have been carrying something for a while. Today I want to try — just try — putting it down."

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 4

1

Distribute Stones

3 MIN

Each student receives a stone (or substitute object). They hold it in their hand. "Feel the weight. Notice how it feels in your hand."

2

The Stone Holds the Heavy

5 MIN

Frame the practice: "Right now — your stone is holding ONE small heavy thing. It can be a mistake you made. Or a hurt feeling. Or a mean thing you said to yourself. You do NOT have to tell anyone what it is. You just hold it in the stone.**"

3

Putting It Down

8 MIN

Hold up the basket. "When you are ready — walk up and put your stone in the basket. That is your way of saying: 'I am putting this down for today.'" One at a time, with quiet music if helpful, students place their stones. Sammy goes first. No commentary required.

IN-LESSON SCAN

Watch for any student who seems unable to put the stone down, who places it and immediately takes it back, or who becomes very emotional during the placement. These are meaningful signals. Do not press. Note privately.

4

It Is a Practice

4 MIN

Land the most important point: "Putting it down does not mean it is gone forever. It might come back. That is OKAY. We put it down again. And again. Each time — we get a little better at it. This is a PRACTICE.**"

KINDERGARTEN

GRADES 1-2

EXIT TICKET

"Touch your hand to your heart and say: "I can put it down. I can put it down again."" Sammy: thumbs-up to every hand. No commentary. Sammy validates participation, not content.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Which students returned for the stone? Which placed it without hesitation? Which became visibly emotional during the placement? Each pattern is meaningful. Note privately for counselor.

SAFETY CHECK

POST-LESSON CLOSE-OUT · Any student who became significantly emotional during the placement, who could not place the stone at all, or who shared a heavy specific item afterward — brief the counselor today.

Did anything arise today requiring counselor follow-up? ☐ No ☐ Yes — contact counselor today

FAMILY CONNECTION

Today we practised putting something heavy down — not forgetting it, just choosing to set it down for now. At home, you might use the same image: "What is one thing you would like to put down before bed tonight?"

SCENARIO CARDS · UNIT 2 · LESSON 5

Print · Cut vertically · Laminate · Reuse year after year

When It's Hard to Forgive Yourself

25–30 min · Week 13 · ★★ HIGHEST RISK · Counselor On-Site

OBJECTIVE	Students articulate that self-forgiveness is a practice, not a destination, and identify trusted adults they can talk to when self-forgiveness feels too hard.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Management · managing persistent self-criticism; help-seeking
VOCABULARY	self-forgiveness · practice · stuck · trusted adult · support web · not alone
MATERIALS	Sammy puppet · When Self-Forgiveness Feels Hard anchor chart · Support Web drawing paper · COUNSELOR PHYSICALLY ON-SITE FULL LESSON

SAFETY CHECK

★★ HIGHEST RISK — COUNSELOR PHYSICALLY ON-SITE THE FULL LESSON. NO EXCEPTIONS. NO SUBSTITUTES. This lesson surfaces persistent self-criticism. A small number of students may show signs of significant emotional load — stuck rumination, intense self-blame, or signs they cannot let something go on their own. An empty Support Web (a student who cannot name any trusted adult) is a HIGH-CONCERN safety signal. Brief the counselor on-site immediately. Crisis resources visible: 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline · Crisis Text Line: HOME to 741741.

OPENING REVIEW · 1–2 MIN

Show the stones-in-basket from Lesson 5. "Last lesson: we practised putting something down. But what about when we put it down — and it comes back? And keeps coming back?*"

SAMMY · KIND COACH VOICE

"I keep putting something down. And it keeps coming back. Sometimes it feels too hard to put down. What do I do?"

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 4

I

Step One — Keep Putting It Down

5 MIN

Validate the difficulty: "Sometimes a heavy thing comes back. That is NORMAL. You did not fail — you are practising. Each time you put it down — you get a little better at it. Self-forgiveness is a PRACTICE, not a destination.**"

2

Step Two — Talk to Someone You Trust

6 MIN

Introduce the support web: "When something is too heavy to put down alone — you talk to a trusted adult. You do NOT carry it alone. A trusted adult can help you understand what to do. That is what they are FOR." Build the Support Web together.

3

Step Three — Remember the Practice

5 MIN

Continue: "Self-forgiveness is not something you do ONCE. It is something you keep CHOOSING. Each time it comes back — you choose again. That is the practice. That is enough.**"

4

Step Four — Ask the Question

4 MIN

The final step: "When you are stuck — ask: 'Have I done what fixing it requires?' If you have apologized, made the change, and tried to repair — the punishing feelings can stop. They are not helping anymore. The work is done.**"

Sammy: "I am not alone. I do not have to carry this by myself."

KINDERGARTEN

GRADES 1-2

EXIT TICKET

"Hold up your Support Web. The counselor and teacher both bow to the Webs. "These are the people who can help you carry the heavy things."" Sammy: thumbs-up to every hand. No commentary. Sammy validates participation, not content.

TEACHER REFLECTION

CRITICAL: any student whose Support Web is empty, includes only an unsafe person, or is named a person already known to be unsafe — brief the counselor BEFORE end of day. This is the most important reflection of the year.

SAFETY CHECK

POST-LESSON CLOSE-OUT · Empty Support Webs and signs of acute self-blame — counselor follow-up TODAY. This is not optional. This lesson exists to surface these students. The follow-up is the work. **Did anything arise today requiring counselor follow-up?** ☐ No ☐ Yes — contact counselor today

FAMILY CONNECTION

Today we built a Support Web — the trusted adults a child can talk to when something is too heavy. Ask your child to show you their Support Web. If they could not name anyone, contact the school counselor today.

ANCHOR CHART · UNIT 2 · LESSON 6

Print this page · Laminate for durability · Post in classroom · Keep posted all year

UNIT 2 · LESSON 6 · THE FOUNDATION (K-2)
DRAWING EXAMPLE · UNIT 2 · LESSON 6

Visual reference for the drawing activity

Unit 2 Wrap-Up — I Put It Down

25–30 min · Week 14 · Unit 2 Wrap-Up

OBJECTIVE	Students consolidate the work of Unit 2 and write a future-self letter — a sealed message about what they are putting down today, to be opened in Unit 4.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Management · consolidation; symbolic future-anchoring
VOCABULARY	put down · practice · kind · future me · letter
MATERIALS	Sammy puppet · envelope per student · letter paper · pens · storage box (for sealed letters) · the four Unit 2 anchor charts

OPENING REVIEW · 1–2 MIN

Walk past each Unit 2 chart in turn: Forgiveness Myth Busters · Three-Part Real Sorry · Three Parts of Being Kind to Yourself · When Self-Forgiveness Feels Hard. "Look at what we have built together this unit.**"

SAMMY · KIND COACH VOICE

"I have learned a lot this unit. I have learned that I can put things down. I have learned that I am not alone. Today I want to write a letter to ME — the me who lives in May."

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 3

1

The Future-Self Letter

15 MIN

Distribute paper. Each student writes (or dictates, or draws) a letter to themselves — the version of themselves they will be in May. Prompts: "One thing I am putting down today is... · One kind thing I want to say to my May-self is... · One thing I want to remember is..." Sammy writes one too.

IN-LESSON SCAN

Watch for any student who cannot generate any content. They may be carrying too much to even name it. Crouch down warmly: "Want help getting started?" Do not pressure. Note for counselor follow-up.

2

Sealing Ritual

8 MIN

Each student folds their letter, places it in their envelope, and seals it. Write their name on the outside. Sammy seals his too. The teacher places all sealed envelopes in the storage box. "We will open these in May, in Unit 4. They will be a surprise — from the YOU of today, to the YOU of then."

3

Bridge to Unit 3

4 MIN

Sammy: "We have learned about ourselves. We have learned how to be kind to ourselves and put things down. Next, we learn how to forgive others — when someone has hurt US. That is Unit 3. It starts in January."

KINDERGARTEN

GRADES 1-2

EXIT TICKET

"Touch your hand to the storage box and say: "Future me — I will see you in May."" Sammy: thumbs-up to every hand. No commentary. Sammy validates participation, not content.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Did students engage with the future-self frame? Who could not write a letter at all? Who sealed it casually? Who sealed it carefully? Each speaks to how seriously they took the unit.

SAFETY CHECK

POST-LESSON CLOSE-OUT · STORE THE LETTERS SECURELY. They MUST be retrievable for U4 L7. Loss of letters is a significant breach of student trust. **Did anything arise today requiring counselor follow-up?** ☐

No ☐ Yes — contact counselor today

FAMILY CONNECTION

Today we ended Unit 2 by writing letters to our future selves — sealed messages to be opened in May. Ask your child: "What is one thing you put down today?" Listen. Do not solve.

UNIT 3



Empathy & Forgiving Others

Your Hurt Is Real

20–25 min • Week 15 • Unit 3 Begins

OBJECTIVE	Students articulate that real hurt deserves to be named, and that forgiveness begins with acknowledging the hurt — not skipping over it.
CASEL FOCUS	Social Awareness • validation of emotional experience; Self-Awareness: naming hurt
VOCABULARY	hurt • real • name it • acknowledge • validate • feelings count
MATERIALS	Sammy puppet • chart paper • scenario cards (Unit 3 Lesson 1 cards)

SAFETY CHECK

STANDING SAFETY NOTE — ALL UNIT 3 LESSONS: This unit never asks students to forgive anyone who is currently harming them. If a student's responses suggest an ongoing harmful situation, pause the lesson and follow the Disclosure Protocol immediately.

OPENING REVIEW • 1–2 MIN

Reference the storage box of future-self letters. "Last unit: we learned to put down what WE were carrying. This unit: we learn what to do when someone has HURT us. We start by saying: your hurt is real.**"

SAMMY • KIND COACH VOICE

"When something hurts — sometimes people say 'it's no big deal' or 'get over it.' But the hurt is REAL. Today we say so."

DIRECT INSTRUCTION • STEPS 1 — 4

1

Naming Real Hurt

5 MIN

Frame the unit: "When someone hurts you — with words, with actions, with leaving you out — your hurt is REAL. We do not skip over it. We do not pretend. We name it: 'This hurt me. It still hurts.' Naming the hurt is the FIRST step — not forgiveness.**"

2

Sammy's Story

6 MIN

Sammy shares (with appropriate distance): "Last week, a friend said something mean about me to other friends. I heard about it. It hurt. People kept telling me 'just forget it.' But I could not. I needed to NAME it first. 'What they said hurt me.' Once I said that out loud — I could start thinking about what to do."

Sammy: "My hurt is real. Saying it out loud helps."

3

Words for Real Hurt

6 MIN

Build a small chart together: words children can use to name real hurt. Examples: "That hurt me." / "I felt left out." / "Those words made me feel small." / "I did not deserve that." Discuss: who can you say these words TO? (a trusted adult, a journal, a friend, yourself.)

4

Closing

4 MIN

Land the through-line: "Forgiveness is NOT skipping over the hurt. Forgiveness BEGINS with naming the hurt. If you cannot say 'it hurt' — you cannot let it go. Today we practised the first step.**"

KINDERGARTEN

GRADES 1-2

EXIT TICKET

"My hurt is real" — say it together, three times. Sammy bows to each saying." Sammy: thumbs-up to every hand. No commentary. Sammy validates participation, not content.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Which students could not name any hurt — even hypothetically? Which named hurts that suggest current ongoing harm? Each is meaningful. Note for counselor coordination.

SAFETY CHECK

POST-LESSON CLOSE-OUT · Any student whose named hurt suggests ongoing harm — follow the Disclosure Protocol. Do NOT coach toward forgiveness when someone is currently being hurt. **Did anything arise today requiring counselor follow-up?** ☐ No ☐ Yes — contact counselor today

FAMILY CONNECTION

Today we learned that real hurt deserves to be named — not skipped. At home, when your child shares a hurt, try first: "That sounds like it really hurt. Tell me more." Validation BEFORE problem-solving.

SCENARIO CARDS · UNIT 3 · LESSON 1

Print · Cut vertically · Laminate · Reuse year after year

DRAWING EXAMPLE · UNIT 3 · LESSON 1

Visual reference for the drawing activity

Why Do People Hurt People?

20–25 min • Week 16

OBJECTIVE	Students explore the gap between intent and impact, and articulate that understanding WHY someone hurt them does not mean what they did was okay.
CASEL FOCUS	Social Awareness • perspective-taking; intent vs. impact
VOCABULARY	why • reason • intent • impact • understanding • not the same as okay
MATERIALS	Sammy puppet • chart paper • scenario cards (Unit 3 Lesson 2 cards)

OPENING REVIEW • 1–2 MIN

Show the "Words for Real Hurt" chart from Lesson 1. "Last lesson: name the hurt. Today: WHY do people hurt people in the first place? And does WHY matter?*" "

SAMMY • KIND COACH VOICE

"Sometimes when someone hurts me, I want to know WHY. Did they mean to? Did they have a hard day? Did they not know? Does the WHY matter?"

DIRECT INSTRUCTION • STEPS 1 — 4

1 Why People Hurt People 5 MIN

Build a chart of reasons (not excuses): "Sometimes people hurt people because... they are tired. They are hurting themselves. They did not see what they did. They were trying to fit in. They did not know better. They were scared. They were copying someone." None of these make hurt OKAY — but understanding helps.**"

2 Intent vs. Impact 6 MIN

Introduce the distinction: "Sometimes people MEAN to hurt us. Sometimes they DON'T mean to. Either way — the hurt is REAL. We can understand the WHY — AND still say the impact was real. Both are true.**"

3 Two Stories 7 MIN

Tell two short stories using scenario cards: one where the person meant to hurt, one where they did not. Discuss: was the hurt the same? (yes.) Did the WHY make a difference in how to respond? (yes — a little.) Did the WHY make it okay? (no.)

4

The Two-Part Truth

4 MIN

Land the lesson: "Understanding WHY someone hurt me is NOT the same as saying it was okay. I can hold BOTH. 'They did not mean to AND it still hurt.' 'They were having a hard day AND that does not make it okay.' Both. Both. Both.**"

Sammy: "I can understand AND still feel hurt."

KINDERGARTEN

GRADES 1-2

EXIT TICKET

"I can understand AND still feel hurt" — say it together. Hold up two fingers — both truths." Sammy: thumbs-up to every hand. No commentary. Sammy validates participation, not content.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Which students collapsed into one truth (only the WHY matters) or the other (only the HURT matters)? Holding both is the developmental work. Note for differentiated support.

SAFETY CHECK

POST-LESSON CLOSE-OUT · Any student who insisted "they did not mean to" about an ongoing harmful situation — may be making excuses for someone who is currently hurting them. Counselor follow-up. **Did anything arise today requiring counselor follow-up?** ☐ No ☐ Yes — contact counselor today

FAMILY CONNECTION

Today we practised holding two truths: "they may not have meant to" AND "the hurt was real." At home, when your child reports a hurt, validate first: "That hurt. That is real." Understanding the why can come AFTER.

SCENARIO CARDS · UNIT 3 · LESSON 2

Print · Cut vertically · Laminate · Reuse year after year

Forgiving Is Not the Same as Trusting

25–30 min · Week 17 · ★★ HIGHEST RISK · Counselor On-Site

OBJECTIVE	Students distinguish between forgiveness (an inner choice for their own peace) and trust (a between-people thing that must be earned), and articulate that forgiving someone does not mean staying close to them.
CASEL FOCUS	Social Awareness · relationship judgment; Relationship Skills: discernment about closeness
VOCABULARY	forgive · trust · earn · inside · between people · not the same · never owed
MATERIALS	Sammy puppet · Forgiveness vs. Trust anchor chart · scenario cards (Unit 3 Lesson 3 cards) · COUNSELOR PHYSICALLY ON-SITE FULL LESSON

SAFETY CHECK

★★ HIGHEST RISK — COUNSELOR PHYSICALLY ON-SITE THE FULL LESSON. NO EXCEPTIONS. This lesson explicitly affirms students do NOT have to be close to people who have hurt them. Some students may be in situations where this affirmation comes as new information — and may be relieved or distressed. CRITICAL: forgiveness is NEVER required when someone is still hurting them. State this explicitly multiple times. Crisis resources visible: 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline · Crisis Text Line: HOME to 741741.

OPENING REVIEW · 1–2 MIN

Show the two-truths chart from Lesson 2. "Last lesson: understand the why AND name the hurt. Today: even if I forgive someone — do I have to be close to them again?*"

SAMMY · KIND COACH VOICE

"Someone hurt me. I am thinking about forgiving them — for ME. But I do not feel safe being close to them anymore. Is that okay?"

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 4



Two Different Things

5 MIN

Frame the central distinction: "Forgiveness and trust are two DIFFERENT things. Forgiveness is INSIDE — it is for YOUR peace. Trust is BETWEEN people — it is about safety. You can give forgiveness alone. You cannot give trust alone — the other person has to EARN it back.**"

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3 · THE FOUNDATION (K-2)

2

Build the Two Columns

7 MIN

Build the anchor chart together. **FORGIVENESS** column: Inside · For your own peace · Can happen alone · Needs nothing from the other person · A gift you give yourself. **TRUST** column: Between people · For the safety of the relationship · Needs both people to be ready · Earned through real change · Never owed — you don't have to give it.

3

The Critical Affirmation

6 MIN

State explicitly, more than once: "You can FORGIVE someone and STILL choose not to be close to them. That is not mean. That is WISE. Forgiveness is for your peace. Trust is earned — NEVER owed. AND — forgiveness is NEVER required when someone is still hurting you.**"

4

Closing

4 MIN

Sammy: "I can forgive someone for my OWN peace — and still keep my distance. My safety matters. My peace matters. Both can be true.**"

Sammy: "Forgiveness is for me. Trust must be earned."

KINDERGARTEN

GRADES 1-2

EXIT TICKET

"'Forgiveness is for me. Trust must be earned.'" — say it together, twice. The counselor and teacher both bow." Sammy: thumbs-up to every hand. No commentary. Sammy validates participation, not content.

TEACHER REFLECTION

CRITICAL: any student who insisted they **MUST** forgive **AND** trust someone who is still hurting them — brief the counselor immediately. They may be receiving harmful messages elsewhere.

SAFETY CHECK

POST-LESSON CLOSE-OUT · Counselor coordinates same-day debrief with teacher. Identify all students whose responses suggested ongoing harmful situations. Disclosure Protocol for any direct disclosures. **Did anything arise today requiring counselor follow-up?** ☐ No ☐ Yes — contact counselor today

FAMILY CONNECTION

Today we learned that forgiveness and trust are two different things. We can forgive **AND** not be close again. **AND** — forgiveness is never required when someone is still hurting us. Reinforce at home: your child does **NOT** have to forgive someone who is still being unkind.

ANCHOR CHART · UNIT 3 · LESSON 3

Print this page · Laminate for durability · Post in classroom · Keep posted all year

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3 · THE FOUNDATION (K-2)

SCENARIO CARDS · UNIT 3 · LESSON 3

Print · Cut vertically · Laminate · Reuse year after year

DRAWING EXAMPLE · UNIT 3 · LESSON 3

Visual reference for the drawing activity

Forgiveness Takes Time

20–25 min · Week 18

OBJECTIVE	Students articulate that forgiveness is not a straight line — setbacks are normal and not failure.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Management · patience with self; Self-Awareness: noticing emotional progress
VOCABULARY	path · not a straight line · setback · practice · okay where you are
MATERIALS	Sammy puppet · The Forgiveness Path anchor chart · sticky dots (one per student)

OPENING REVIEW · 1–2 MIN

Show the Forgiveness vs. Trust chart. "Last lesson: forgiveness is for our peace. Today: forgiveness is a PATH. And the path is not a straight line.**"

SAMMY · KIND COACH VOICE

"I thought I had forgiven someone. Then yesterday — I felt mad about it again. Did I do it WRONG?"

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 4

1

The Path Is Not Straight

5 MIN

Frame the lesson: "Forgiveness is a PATH — not a straight line. Some days are easier. Some days the hurt comes back. That is NOT failure. That is the path. Wherever you are on the path — it is OKAY.**"

2

Walk the Six Stations

8 MIN

Walk through the six stations on the anchor chart: 1. STILL HURTING. 2. STARTING TO UNDERSTAND. 3. SOME DAYS ARE BETTER. 4. CHOOSING TO PUT IT DOWN TODAY. 5. THE HURT IS GETTING SMALLER. 6. I AM OKAY. At each: "What might it feel like here? What might it sound like to YOU?"

3

Sticky-Dot Activity

7 MIN

Distribute one sticky dot per student. "Place your dot on the station where YOU are today — about a hurt you are working on. This is anonymous — nobody has to know which dot is yours. Wherever you are — it is OKAY." Quiet music. No commentary required.

IN-LESSON SCAN

Watch for any student who places at Station 1 with intensity, who refuses to place at all, or who places multiple dots. These are meaningful signals. Note privately.

4

The Practice Is the Path

4 MIN

Land the closing: "Moving backward on the path is NOT failure. It IS the practice. You put it down again. Each time — you get a little better at it. Wherever you are today — you are exactly where you need to be.**"

KINDERGARTEN

GRADES 1-2

EXIT TICKET

"Wherever I am on the path — it is okay" — say it together. Touch the dot you placed (without showing others)." Sammy: thumbs-up to every hand. No commentary. Sammy validates participation, not content.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Where did the dots cluster? Did dots cluster at "Still Hurting"? At "I Am Okay"? Did anyone place dots in scattered places? The pattern reveals the unit's emotional weight.

SAFETY CHECK

POST-LESSON CLOSE-OUT · A student who placed at Station 1 with significant emotional intensity — brief the counselor for awareness. Repeated placement at Station 1 across lessons may indicate ongoing harm.

Did anything arise today requiring counselor follow-up? ☐ No ☐ Yes — contact counselor today

FAMILY CONNECTION

Today we learned that forgiveness is a PATH, not a straight line. At home, when your child seems to "go backward" on something they had moved past, normalize: "That happens. Even grown-ups have setbacks. You are practising."

ANCHOR CHART · UNIT 3 · LESSON 4

Print this page · Laminate for durability · Post in classroom · Keep posted all year

SCENARIO CARDS · UNIT 3 · LESSON 4

Print · Cut vertically · Laminate · Reuse year after year

DRAWING EXAMPLE · UNIT 3 · LESSON 4

Visual reference for the drawing activity

My Story Is Not the Whole Me

25–30 min · Week 19 · ★ ELEVATED · Counselor On-Site

OBJECTIVE	Students articulate that what happened to them is NOT who they are — they are more than their story.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness · narrative identity; Social Awareness: self in context
VOCABULARY	story · what happened · what I told myself · who I am now · more than my story
MATERIALS	Sammy puppet · My Three-Panel Story anchor chart · three-panel drawing paper · COUNSELOR ON-SITE

SAFETY CHECK

★ ELEVATED RISK — COUNSELOR ON-SITE. PANEL 1 (What Happened) IS ALWAYS PRIVATE. Students do NOT share unless they choose to. State this multiple times. A student's Panel 1 may surface real hurt experiences — some that may need follow-up. The counselor reviews privately afterward, with student consent.

OPENING REVIEW · 1–2 MIN

Show the Forgiveness Path chart. "Last lesson: wherever you are is okay. Today: what we BELIEVE about ourselves — because of what happened to us — may not be the whole truth.**"

SAMMY · KIND COACH VOICE

"Something hard happened to me a while ago. I told myself a story about what it MEANT — about ME. But maybe that story is not true. Maybe I am MORE than my story."

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 4

1

Three Panels, Three Truths

6 MIN

Build the framework: "Panel 1: WHAT HAPPENED — a real hurt. This is ALWAYS private. Panel 2: THE STORY I TOLD MYSELF — what I decided about ME because of it. Panel 3: WHO I AM NOW — the actual person I am today, with what I have learned and what I carry. PANEL 3 IS BIGGER THAN PANEL 1.**"

2

Sammy's Three-Panel

5 MIN

Sammy models with appropriate distance: "Panel 1 — [private]. Panel 2 — I told myself I was unlovable. Panel 3 — I am someone who is learning to be kind to myself, who has friends, who knows that what happened was not my fault. I am MORE than Panel 1."

Sammy: "My story is real. AND I am more than my story."

3

Three-Panel Drawing

10 MIN

Distribute three-panel paper. Students fill in Panel 2 and Panel 3 — NEVER required to fill in Panel 1. They can draw, write, or both. Privacy protocol: never collected, never displayed, students keep or destroy.

IN-LESSON SCAN

Counselor and teacher both circulate. Watch for students who write significant content in Panel 2 (heavy self-stories). They may need follow-up. Do not press during the activity.

4

The Closing Truth

4 MIN

Land the message: "Your story is REAL — and you are MORE than your story. Panel 1 is always private. Panel 2 is a belief — not always the truth. Panel 3 is who you are BECOMING.**"

KINDERGARTEN

GRADES 1-2

EXIT TICKET

"My story is real. AND I am MORE than my story." — say it together. Sammy bows." Sammy: thumbs-up to every hand. No commentary. Sammy validates participation, not content.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Counselor and teacher debrief same day. Students whose Panel 2 stories were heavy — brief discussion about who needs follow-up. The activity is the screen.

SAFETY CHECK

POST-LESSON CLOSE-OUT · Counselor schedules same-week individual check-ins with any students whose Panel 2 was particularly heavy. NOT mandatory — offered warmly. Disclosure Protocol for any explicit disclosures. **Did anything arise today requiring counselor follow-up?** ☐ No ☐ Yes — contact counselor today

FAMILY CONNECTION

Today we practised that we are MORE than what happened to us. At home, if a child voices a "story I told myself" (e.g., "I am the bad one in my family"), gently reflect: "That is one story. Tell me a story about who you are NOW."

ANCHOR CHART · UNIT 3 · LESSON 5

Print this page · Laminate for durability · Post in classroom · Keep posted all year

Forgiveness Stories

20–25 min · Week 20

OBJECTIVE	Students hear stories of others practising forgiveness, and articulate that forgiveness happens in many forms across many cultures.
CASEL FOCUS	Social Awareness · cultural perspective; Self-Management: consolidation
VOCABULARY	stories · many ways · examples · practice · shared experience
MATERIALS	Mentor texts: <i>After the Fall</i> (Dan Santat) and/or <i>Each Kindness</i> (Jacqueline Woodson) · Sammy puppet · chart paper

OPENING REVIEW · 1–2 MIN

Show the three-panel drawings (briefly, respectfully). "Last lesson: we are more than our stories. Today: stories of OTHER people practising forgiveness.**"

SAMMY · KIND COACH VOICE

"Forgiveness looks different in every story. Today we hear how some others have walked the path."

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 3

1

Read-Aloud · After the Fall

10 MIN

Read *After the Fall* by Dan Santat with full presence. Discussion as you read: "How is Humpty Dumpty changing?" "What is he afraid of?" "What does he choose at the end?" The story directly maps to the Three-Panel framework: Panel 1 (the fall), Panel 2 (the fear story he told himself), Panel 3 (who he becomes).

2

What This Story Tells Us

6 MIN

Discuss the takeaway: "Humpty Dumpty did not pretend the fall did not happen. He did not skip over the fear. He named it. He worked with it. Slowly. He became MORE than his fall. That is forgiveness too — of himself.**"

3

Stories We Carry

7 MIN

Pose the question: "Do you have a small story of forgiveness you have seen — in your family, in a book, in a movie? It does NOT have to be your own story." Take 3–4 voluntary shares. Sammy listens warmly.

IN-LESSON SCAN

A student whose share suggests an ongoing harmful situation — do NOT redirect publicly. Note privately for counselor follow-up.

EXIT TICKET

"Each student names one moment in After the Fall (or another story) where they felt the forgiveness path was happening." Sammy: thumbs-up to every hand. No commentary. Sammy validates participation, not content.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Which students engaged deeply with Humpty's fear? Which seemed to map their own story onto his? The mentor text often does the work no other lesson can do.

SAFETY CHECK

POST-LESSON CLOSE-OUT · Standard close-out. No specific risk this lesson, but Unit 3 cumulative load means ongoing attentiveness to students showing signs of overwhelm. **Did anything arise today requiring counselor follow-up?** ☐ No ☐ Yes — contact counselor today

FAMILY CONNECTION

Today we read After the Fall by Dan Santat — a story about a small character who learned to be brave again after a hard fall. Read it again at home if available. Ask: "What did Humpty do that was brave?"

Unit 3 Wrap-Up — I Choose

25–30 min • Week 21 • Unit 3 Wrap-Up

OBJECTIVE	Students consolidate Unit 3 by writing a personal "I CHOOSE" statement — affirming their right to choose forgiveness, distance, or both.
CASEL FOCUS	Relationship Skills • agency; Responsible Decision-Making: claiming personal choice
VOCABULARY	I choose • agency • my choice • not owed • for me
MATERIALS	Sammy puppet • the four Unit 3 anchor charts • "I CHOOSE" statement paper • pens

OPENING REVIEW • 1–2 MIN

Walk past the four Unit 3 charts: Forgiveness vs. Trust • The Forgiveness Path • My Three-Panel Story • the Words for Real Hurt chart. "Look at what we have built. Today — we claim our choice.**"

SAMMY • KIND COACH VOICE

"I have learned that nobody can MAKE me forgive. Forgiveness is MINE. Trust is MINE. Today I write what I CHOOSE."

DIRECT INSTRUCTION • STEPS 1 — 3

1

My Three Choices

5 MIN

Frame the statement: "Today you write THREE things. Number 1: I choose to FORGIVE ____ for my own peace — OR — I choose to TAKE TIME before forgiving. Number 2: I choose to TRUST again — OR — I choose to KEEP MY DISTANCE. Number 3: I choose to be KIND to myself about this. ALL of these are valid.**"

2

Writing the Statement

12 MIN

Distribute paper. Students write (or dictate, or draw) their "I CHOOSE" statement — about a real or imagined situation. Privacy protocol: never collected, never displayed, students keep. Sammy writes one too.

IN-LESSON SCAN

Watch for any student whose statement includes forgiving someone who is currently hurting them. This is a high-concern signal. Do not redirect publicly. Counselor follow-up.

3

Bridge to Unit 4

6 MIN

Sammy: "We have learned to forgive others — for our peace. We have learned that trust is earned. Next: we learn what it means to GIVE GRACE — to be kind to people who have not earned it. Why would we do that? Unit 4 starts in April."

KINDERGARTEN

GRADES 1-2

EXIT TICKET

"Touch your hand to your statement and say: "This is what I CHOOSE."" Sammy: thumbs-up to every hand. No commentary. Sammy validates participation, not content.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Which choices appeared most? Forgiveness with distance? Forgiveness with closeness? Not yet ready to forgive? The pattern reveals what the unit produced for the class.

SAFETY CHECK

POST-LESSON CLOSE-OUT · A student who chose forgiveness AND closeness with someone who is currently hurting them — counselor follow-up before Unit 4 begins. **Did anything arise today requiring counselor follow-up?** ☐ No ☐ Yes — contact counselor today

FAMILY CONNECTION

We finished Unit 3 today. Ask your child: "What did you CHOOSE in your statement?" Listen without correcting. Their choice is theirs.



UNIT 4



Grace & Generosity



What Does Grace Look Like?

20–25 min • Week 22 • Unit 4 Begins

OBJECTIVE	Students define grace as kindness given to someone who has not earned it, and distinguish grace from being a doormat (kindness without agency).
CASEL FOCUS	Responsible Decision-Making • defining values; Social Awareness: extending kindness
VOCABULARY	grace • unearned kindness • generous • doormat • choice • strength
MATERIALS	Sammy puppet • Grace vs. Doormat anchor chart • scenario cards (Unit 4 Lesson 1 cards)

OPENING REVIEW • 1–2 MIN

Show the "I CHOOSE" statements (briefly, respectfully). "Last unit: forgiveness for OUR peace. This unit: a different question. What does it mean to give kindness someone has NOT earned? That is GRACE.**"

SAMMY • KIND COACH VOICE

"Grace is a big word. It means giving someone kindness, patience, or a second chance — even when they have NOT earned it. Why would we do that?"

DIRECT INSTRUCTION • STEPS 1 — 4

1

Defining Grace

5 MIN

Build the definition: "GRACE is giving something generous — kindness, patience, a second chance — to someone who has NOT earned it. Grace is a CHOICE — not a rule. Grace is a STRENGTH — not a weakness.**"

2

Grace Is Not a Doormat

6 MIN

Build the second column: "But — grace is NOT being a doormat. A doormat has NO choice. People walk on a doormat. Grace HAS a choice — you decide what you give. You can SAY NO when you need to. You protect your dignity AND give kindness. BOTH.**"

3

Sort the Scenarios

8 MIN

Use scenario cards. For each: is this GRACE or being a DOORMAT? Examples: a friend forgot your birthday and you decide not to make a big deal of it (grace). A friend keeps borrowing your toys without asking and you keep saying nothing (doormat). A new student is mean and you choose to be friendly anyway (grace).
Discuss: what makes the difference? (CHOICE.)

4

Closing

4 MIN

Land the message: "Grace is for the strong. You CHOOSE to give it. You CAN say no. You decide what is generous AND protects your dignity.**"

Sammy: "I give grace because I CHOOSE to."

KINDERGARTEN

GRADES 1-2

EXIT TICKET

"Hold your hand up like an open gift. Say: "Grace is a CHOICE I make."" Sammy: thumbs-up to every hand. No commentary. Sammy validates participation, not content.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Which students collapsed grace into doormat (assumed any kindness was being walked on)? Which collapsed doormat into grace (justified being walked on as "being kind")? Each pattern is meaningful for differentiation.

SAFETY CHECK

POST-LESSON CLOSE-OUT · Any student whose "grace" examples normalized being treated badly — may be in a doormat dynamic with someone in their life. Note for counselor awareness. **Did anything arise today requiring counselor follow-up?** ☐ No ☐ Yes — contact counselor today

FAMILY CONNECTION

Today we defined grace as kindness CHOSEN — given to someone who has not earned it. AND — grace is not a doormat. At home, you might ask: "When is grace WISE? When is it NOT wise?"

ANCHOR CHART · UNIT 4 · LESSON 1

Print this page · Laminate for durability · Post in classroom · Keep posted all year

SCENARIO CARDS · UNIT 4 · LESSON 1

Print · Cut vertically · Laminate · Reuse year after year

DRAWING EXAMPLE · UNIT 4 · LESSON 1

Visual reference for the drawing activity

What Does Mercy Look Like?

20–25 min · Week 23

OBJECTIVE	Students explore mercy as a relative of grace — specifically the choice to lessen consequences someone DID earn.
CASEL FOCUS	Responsible Decision-Making · values clarification; Social Awareness: mercy in community
VOCABULARY	mercy · consequence · earned · lessen · generous · judgment
MATERIALS	Sammy puppet · chart paper · story examples

OPENING REVIEW · 1–2 MIN

Show the Grace vs. Doormat chart. "Last lesson: grace is unearned kindness. Today: a relative of grace called MERCY.**"

SAMMY · KIND COACH VOICE

"Sometimes someone DOES earn a consequence. They messed up. And someone CHOOSES to lessen the consequence anyway. That is MERCY."

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 4

1

Defining Mercy

5 MIN

Build the definition: "MERCY is choosing to lessen a consequence someone HAS earned. They messed up — and you give them less than what was deserved. Mercy is a CHOICE — like grace. Mercy is a kind of generous.**"

2

Two Stories

8 MIN

Tell two short stories: a child who lost a borrowed item gets a smaller punishment than expected (mercy). A teacher gives extra recess after a hard week even though it was not earned (grace). Discuss: which is mercy and which is grace? (Mercy = lessening earned consequence. Grace = giving unearned generosity.)

3

When Is Mercy Wise?

7 MIN

Pose the harder question: "When is mercy WISE? When the person seems to be learning. When the person has been working hard. When safety is not at risk. When is mercy NOT wise? When someone keeps doing the same hurtful thing. When safety is at risk. When mercy enables more harm.**"

4

Closing

4 MIN

Land the through-line: "Mercy is a CHOICE — not a rule. Wise mercy looks at: are they learning? Is safety okay? Then — you choose.**"

KINDERGARTEN

GRADES 1-2

EXIT TICKET

"Mercy is a CHOICE" — say it together. Hold up an open hand." Sammy: thumbs-up to every hand. No commentary. Sammy validates participation, not content.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Which students could differentiate mercy from grace? Which conflated them? Which understood mercy without conditions? Which qualified it wisely?

SAFETY CHECK

POST-LESSON CLOSE-OUT · A student who described a situation where they felt forced to give "mercy" to someone harmful — may be in a coercive dynamic. Note for counselor awareness. **Did anything arise today requiring counselor follow-up?** ☐ No ☐ Yes — contact counselor today

FAMILY CONNECTION

Today we explored MERCY — choosing to lessen a consequence someone earned. At home, when you give your child a smaller consequence than expected, name it: "I am giving you mercy on this one because..." Naming the gift makes it visible.

Giving the Benefit of the Doubt

20–25 min · Week 24 · Permanent Post

OBJECTIVE	Students learn the four-step Pause Practice for charitable interpretation, and articulate that we usually give the benefit of the doubt to people we like — the practice begins where the kind story runs out.
CASEL FOCUS	Social Awareness · charitable interpretation; Self-Management: pausing reactivity
VOCABULARY	benefit of the doubt · pause · charitable · kind story · first thought · choose
MATERIALS	Sammy puppet · The Pause Practice anchor chart · scenario cards (Unit 4 Lesson 3 cards)

OPENING REVIEW · 1–2 MIN

Show the Mercy chart. "Last lesson: mercy is a choice. Today: a tool we use BEFORE we even know if mercy is needed. We use it when something happens and we don't know WHY.**"

SAMMY · KIND COACH VOICE

"Someone bumped into me in the hall. I didn't know if they did it on purpose. My brain said 'mean!' But — wait — there is another way to see this."

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 5

- Step 1 · Something Happens** 3 MIN
 Begin: "Something ambiguous happens. You do not know WHY someone did what they did. Did they mean to? Did they not see? Were they having a hard day? You do not know. Yet.**"
- Step 2 · Notice Your First Thought** 4 MIN
 Continue: "Your brain has a FIRST thought. 'They did it on purpose!' 'They are mean!' NOTICE the thought. Do NOT act on it yet. Just notice.**"
- Step 3 · Pause** 4 MIN
 The crucial step: "PAUSE. Ask: 'What is another way to see this — a kind one?' Maybe they did not see you. Maybe they were rushing to help someone. Maybe they were having a hard day. A KIND story might be true.**"
- Step 4 · Act on the Kind Story** 5 MIN
 The action: "Unless you KNOW for sure — act on the KIND story. 'They probably did not see me.' 'They are probably having a hard day.' You can be wrong about this. You usually won't be.**"

5

Where the Kind Story Runs Out

5 MIN

Land the deepest point: "Notice WHO you give the kind story to. Probably people you LIKE. The real practice begins where your kind story RUNS OUT — with people you don't like, people who annoy you, people who have hurt you before. THAT is the practice.**"

Sammy: "I give the kind story to people I like. The practice is giving it to people I don't."

KINDERGARTEN

GRADES 1-2

EXIT TICKET

"Pause. Choose the kind story." — say it together. Sammy bows." Sammy: thumbs-up to every hand. No commentary. Sammy validates participation, not content.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Which students could not generate a kind alternative explanation? Which generated kind stories quickly? Which only gave kind stories to friends? Each tells you something different.

SAFETY CHECK

POST-LESSON CLOSE-OUT · No specific risk. Standard close-out. **Did anything arise today requiring counselor follow-up?** ☐ No ☐ Yes — contact counselor today

FAMILY CONNECTION

Today we learned the Pause Practice: when something feels unkind, PAUSE and ask: "Is there another way to see this?" At home, model audibly: "I was upset, but then I thought — maybe they were..." Modelling makes the pause learnable.

ANCHOR CHART · UNIT 4 · LESSON 3

Print this page · Laminate for durability · Post in classroom · Keep posted all year

SCENARIO CARDS · UNIT 4 · LESSON 3

Print · Cut vertically · Laminate · Reuse year after year

DRAWING EXAMPLE · UNIT 4 · LESSON 3

Visual reference for the drawing activity

Small Acts, Big Difference

20–25 min · Week 25

OBJECTIVE	Students identify small daily acts of grace that, repeated over time, build community.
CASEL FOCUS	Relationship Skills · daily generosity; Social Awareness: community building
VOCABULARY	small acts · daily · difference · community · practice · consistency
MATERIALS	Sammy puppet · chart paper for class register · small slips of paper

OPENING REVIEW · 1–2 MIN

Show the Pause Practice chart. "Last lesson: choose the kind story. Today: small acts of kindness, every day, that add up.**"

SAMMY · KIND COACH VOICE

"Big acts of grace are wonderful. But the SMALL acts — every day — are what build the world we want to live in."

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 4

1 What Small Acts Look Like 5 MIN

Build a chart of small daily acts: "Saying good morning by NAME. Holding a door. Sharing a pencil. Saving someone's seat. Picking up something they dropped. Saying thank you. Smiling. Looking up when someone speaks." None of these are big. ALL of them count.**"

2 Sammy's Story 5 MIN

Sammy tells: "There is a teacher I know. She learned every student's name in the first week. Every day, she said hello to each one BY NAME. Years later — those students still remember her. That was a SMALL act. It made a BIG difference."

3 The Class Register 8 MIN

Pose the challenge: "Today — we start a class register of small acts. For the rest of the year, when you SEE a small act of grace, write it on a slip and add it to the register. We will read them at the end of the year." Each student writes one small act they have noticed (in their own class) on a slip and adds it.

4 Closing 4 MIN

Land the message: "Big acts of grace are wonderful. SMALL acts — every day — are what BUILD the community we want to live in. Practise the small ones. They count.**"

EXIT TICKET

"Small acts. Every day. They count." — say it together." Sammy: thumbs-up to every hand. No commentary. Sammy validates participation, not content.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Did students notice small acts they had not named before? Did some struggle to come up with any? The capacity to NOTICE is the developmental skill.

SAFETY CHECK

POST-LESSON CLOSE-OUT · No specific risk. Standard close-out. **Did anything arise today requiring counselor follow-up?** ☐ No ☐ Yes — contact counselor today

FAMILY CONNECTION

Today we started a class register of small acts of grace. At home, try noticing one small act per day in your family — and naming it out loud. "I noticed you did..." Naming makes them visible.

SCENARIO CARDS · UNIT 4 · LESSON 4

Print · Cut vertically · Laminate · Reuse year after year

Grace With Hard People

20–25 min · Week 26

OBJECTIVE	Students articulate that grace toward hard people — the rude, prickly, or unkind — is a choice, with limits set by their own safety and dignity.
CASEL FOCUS	Relationship Skills · grace with discernment; Self-Management: limits
VOCABULARY	hard people · prickly · rude · limits · safety · dignity · cost
MATERIALS	Sammy puppet · chart paper · scenario examples

OPENING REVIEW · 1–2 MIN

Show the small acts register. "Last lesson: small acts of grace. Today: what about with people who are HARD to be kind to?*"

SAMMY · KIND COACH VOICE

"There is someone in my life who is prickly. They are not mean exactly — but they are HARD to be kind to. What do I do?"

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 4

1

Hard People Are Real

5 MIN

Validate: "Some people are hard. They are rude sometimes. They are prickly. They make us tense. They are real — in classrooms, in families, in life. We do not have to PRETEND they are easy.**"

2

Choose Your Grace

6 MIN

Build the framework: "With hard people, you CHOOSE your grace. Maybe small — a polite hello. Maybe medium — a kind word when they seem stressed. Maybe big — inviting them to sit with you. YOU decide. The amount can be small. The CHOICE is yours.**"

3

But Limits Are Real Too

6 MIN

State firmly: "AND — grace has LIMITS. If a hard person is hurting you — grace is NOT required. Your SAFETY matters. Your DIGNITY matters. You can give a tiny grace and STILL keep your distance. You can give NO grace if it costs you safety.**"

4

Closing

4 MIN

Land the message: "Grace with hard people is a small CHOICE you make — with your safety and dignity intact. Sometimes the grace is just 'I will not be mean back.' That counts.**"

Sammy: "I choose my grace. I keep my safety."

KINDERGARTEN

GRADES 1-2

EXIT TICKET

"My grace. My safety. Both matter." — say it together." Sammy: thumbs-up to every hand. No commentary. Sammy validates participation, not content.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Which students argued grace MUST be given to anyone? Which argued NO grace is owed to hard people? Both are off-balance. The work is the discernment.

SAFETY CHECK

POST-LESSON CLOSE-OUT · A student who described a hard person who is in fact harming them — follow Disclosure Protocol. Grace is not a salve for ongoing harm. **Did anything arise today requiring counselor follow-up?** ☐ No ☐ Yes — contact counselor today

FAMILY CONNECTION

Today we discussed grace with hard people — with limits. At home, when your child mentions a difficult person, ask: "What is one TINY kind thing you could choose? What is one limit you need to keep?" Both matter.

Grace Audit & Grace Garden

25–30 min · Week 27

OBJECTIVE	Students audit their own grace practice over the year and contribute to a class Grace Garden — a visible record of grace given and received.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness · reflective practice; Social Awareness: community recognition
VOCABULARY	audit · noticing · garden · growth · what counts
MATERIALS	Sammy puppet · Grace Garden display space · paper flowers (one per student) · pens

OPENING REVIEW · 1–2 MIN

Show the small acts register. "Last lesson: grace with hard people. Today: we audit — we notice — our own grace this year. And we plant a garden.**"

SAMMY · KIND COACH VOICE

"I want to look at the year and ask: where did I GIVE grace? Where did I RECEIVE it? That is what an audit is."

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 3

1 My Grace Audit 10 MIN

Distribute paper flowers. Each flower has THREE petals. Petal 1: One time I GAVE grace this year. Petal 2: One time I RECEIVED grace this year. Petal 3: One time I gave myself grace. Students fill in each petal (write or draw).

IN-LESSON SCAN

A student who cannot fill in any petal — may not be noticing the grace around them. Crouch down warmly: "Want help thinking of one?" Do not pressure.

2 The Grace Garden 8 MIN

One at a time, students place their flower in the Grace Garden display. They can name one petal aloud (optional) or place silently. Sammy adds his flower too. The Garden becomes the visible record of the year's grace.

3 What the Garden Shows 6 MIN

Walk around the Garden together. "What do we see? Many small flowers — many small graces. Some big, some tiny. ALL count. This Garden grew because YOU practised. The Garden is YOU.**"

EXIT TICKET

"Touch your hand to your flower and say: "I gave grace this year. I received grace this year. I am part of the Garden."" Sammy: thumbs-up to every hand. No commentary. Sammy validates participation, not content.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Which petal was hardest for the most students? Often the third (giving themselves grace) is. That tells you where Unit 2's self-compassion work needs reinforcement.

SAFETY CHECK

POST-LESSON CLOSE-OUT · No specific risk. Standard close-out. **Did anything arise today requiring counselor follow-up?** ☐ No ☐ Yes — contact counselor today

FAMILY CONNECTION

Today we built a class Grace Garden — one flower per child, three petals each. At home, ask: "Tell me one petal." Listen.

Community Charter & Year-End Celebration

40–45 min · Week 28 · ★ ELEVATED · Counselor on Standby

OBJECTIVE	Students consolidate the year by opening their future-self letters from December, co-creating a Community Charter, and celebrating one year of growth.
CASEL FOCUS	Responsible Decision-Making · consolidation; Relationship Skills: community
VOCABULARY	charter · community · celebrate · who we became · bridge
MATERIALS	Sealed future-self letters (FROM U2 L7 — MUST be retrieved) · charter poster board · pens · celebration materials · Sammy puppet · COUNSELOR ON STANDBY

SAFETY CHECK

★ ELEVATED RISK — COUNSELOR ON STANDBY (reachable, available same-day). The future-self letters from December are emotionally weighted. Students may have changed dramatically; some may not have. Some letters may now feel painful to read. Reserve the right to allow a student to NOT open their letter publicly. They may keep it sealed.

OPENING REVIEW · 1–2 MIN

Walk past every chart in the classroom — every chart from every unit. "Look at what we built. Look at who we became. Look at the year.**"

SAMMY · KIND COACH VOICE

"In December I sealed a letter to MYSELF — to the May me. Today I open it. So do you."

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 4

I Open the Letters 15 MIN

Return each sealed envelope to its writer. Three full minutes of silence for reading. "Who did you write TO in December? Who are you NOW in May? What changed?" Optional brief voluntary share — no pressure. Sammy reads his too.

IN-LESSON SCAN

A student who looks distressed reading their letter — may have hoped for change that did not come. Acknowledge privately: "I see this is heavy. We can talk after." Do NOT redirect publicly.

2

Co-Create the Community Charter

15 MIN

Distribute the charter poster. Together, write the Community Charter for next year's class — the lessons WE learned that we want to PASS DOWN. Each student contributes one line. Examples: "Feelings are messengers." "I am not my mistakes." "Forgiveness is for me." "Grace is a choice."

3

Celebration

8 MIN

Celebration moment. Each student says ONE thing they are proud of from the year (their own growth). Sammy responds warmly to each. Class chant: the OOPS → FIX IT → TRY AGAIN chant from Lesson 3 of Unit 1, with the year's wisdom now layered in.

4

Closing of the Year

5 MIN

Final words: "We started the year by saying 'Who am I?' We end the year knowing: I am MORE than my mistakes. I am part of a community. I give grace. I receive grace. I AM — and I am STILL BECOMING. Goodbye for now — but you will carry this work into next year and the year after.**"

Sammy: "I will see you next year. I am proud of who you have become."

KINDERGARTEN

GRADES 1-2

EXIT TICKET

"Each student says: "I am proud of myself for ____." Sammy bows to each." Sammy: thumbs-up to every hand. No commentary. Sammy validates participation, not content.

TEACHER REFLECTION

The deepest reflection of the year. Which students walked into August unable to name themselves — and walked out claiming who they are? Which students did not? The pattern shapes counselor coordination for next year.

SAFETY CHECK

POST-LESSON CLOSE-OUT • Counselor reachable same-day. Year-end dismissal can surface heavy feelings. The Charter and celebration also surface students who have grown deeply — honour that as much as the heavy. **Did anything arise today requiring counselor follow-up?** ☐ No ☐ Yes — contact counselor today

FAMILY CONNECTION

Today we ended the year by opening the letters we sealed in December. Ask your child: "What did your future-self letter say? What did your now-self think reading it?" This is the most important conversation of the year.

SECTION THREE

ASSESSMENT SUITE

Grades K–2 · Pilot Year

3.1 Overview & Administration Timing

The Architecture of Grace Assessment Suite contains eight instruments labelled A through H covering all grade bands. For Book 1 (Grades K–2), the four instruments most relevant to the classroom — and to district reporting for this grade band — are reproduced in full below as Section 3 (Instruments C, E, G, H). They may be photocopied and distributed within the licensed adopting district.

▲ AI INSTRUMENT DISCLOSURE — APPLIES TO ALL INSTRUMENTS BELOW

The instruments in this section were developed by large language models (LLMs) at the recommendation of an AI-generated curriculum review panel. No licensed psychometricians, clinical professionals, or educational measurement specialists participated in instrument design. These are unvalidated working-draft tools for the pilot year. They must be reviewed by a qualified educational measurement specialist before any high-stakes use, including teacher performance evaluation, student placement, referral, or public claims of programme efficacy.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FOUNDATION (K-2)

INSTRUMENTS IN THIS SECTION

C ★ THIS GRADE BAND	Teacher-administered oral protocol · 16 items	Pre: before U1L1 · Post: after U4L7	Self-reported growth across all four unit constructs, calibrated to K-2 development
E	Administrator observation checklist	Once per semester per teacher	Fidelity monitoring during classroom observation
G	Family perception survey · Anonymous	After U2 (mid-year) + after U4 (year-end)	Family awareness and observed child impact
H	District coordinator protocol	Year-long · Coordinator-administered	FERPA compliance, effect size benchmarks, equity analysis

DATA COLLECTION TIMELINE

Week 1 (before U1 L1)	Instrument C · Pre	Classroom teacher · Store by Student ID code, never by name
End of Unit 2	Instrument G · Family	Distributed by teacher · Returned to administrator · Anonymous
September / January / May–June	Administrator Protocol	Building principal or district coordinator · Three checkpoints
Once per semester per teacher	Instrument E · Fidelity	Instructional coach or principal during lesson observation
Final week (after U4 L7)	Instrument C · Post	Same classroom teacher · Compare pre and post
End of Unit 4	Instrument G · Family	Year-end family engagement survey · Anonymous
After post collected	Data summary (Instrument H)	District Assessment Coordinator · Aggregate by grade band only

COUNSELOR COORDINATION REQUIRED

Critical: Pre-assessments must be administered BEFORE Unit 1 Lesson 1 — not during. Post-assessments must use the SAME instrument with the SAME teacher, stored by Student ID code (never by name).

3.2 Built-In Assessment Tools

In addition to the formal instruments below, every lesson in Section 2 contains built-in formative assessment tools. These are not added administrative work — they are the lesson design itself.

Exit Tickets — Closing check at the end of every lesson. Often a single question, single hand-raise, or one-word response. Never collected, never graded.

Teacher Reflection Prompts — A private prompt at the close of every lesson, designed for the teacher — not the students. The reflections accumulate into qualitative data over the year.

In-Lesson Scans — Inline observational prompts placed at the precise activity that warrants observation. Watch for named behaviours. Note privately.

Anchor Chart Co-Construction — Charts are built WITH students, not delivered TO them. The student contributions to each chart are themselves data.

Drawing Activities (Private) — Personal drawings are never collected unless the student offers them. They become artefacts of internal work the teacher can sometimes glimpse.

Future-Self Letters — The sealed letters written in U2 L7 and opened in U4 L7 provide a powerful longitudinal artefact. Preserve carefully.

3.A1

INSTRUMENT C — K-2 PRE/POST ASSESSMENT

Teacher-Administered Oral Protocol · Grades K-2 (The Foundation)

▲ AI INSTRUMENT DISCLOSURE

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WHY ORAL ADMINISTRATION AT K-2

Young children in Kindergarten through Grade 2 are developing their reading and writing skills concurrently with this curriculum. A written survey would conflate literacy skills with SEL construct knowledge. The oral protocol removes that confound: the teacher reads each item aloud, accepts verbal or gestural responses, and records the child's answer. The child's task is simply to say or show what feels true for them right now.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FOUNDATION (K-2)

ADMINISTRATION INSTRUCTIONS

When to administer: Pre-assessment in the first week of school, before Unit 1 Lesson 1. Post-assessment in the final week of the year, after Unit 4 Lesson 7. Allow 8–12 minutes per student. Administer individually during independent work, center rotations, or arrival/dismissal time. Do not administer as a group. How to introduce it: Say: 'I'm going to ask you some questions about yourself. There are no wrong answers — I just want to know what you think. You can point, hold up fingers, or just tell me.' Do not use curriculum vocabulary during introduction — this is a baseline capture, not a review. Recording responses: Use the recording sheet below. Circle or note the child's response for each item. Add brief anecdotal notes where a child's response is unexpected or elaborated. Confidentiality: Recording sheets are stored privately by the teacher. They are not shared with parents, administrators, or other staff except under mandatory reporting obligations.

PART 1 — SELF-AWARENESS & IDENTITY (UNIT 1 CONSTRUCTS)

Read each item aloud. Show the visual anchor card if available. Record the child's verbal or gestural response.

1. Do you know what kinds of things make you happy?	☐	☐	☐
2. When you feel sad or worried, do you know what the feeling is called?	☐	☐	☐
3. When you make a mistake, do you know the difference between 'I did something wrong' and 'I am bad'?	☐	☐	☐
4. Do you think you can learn things even if they are hard at first?	☐	☐	☐

PART 2 — SELF-COMPASSION & SELF-FORGIVENESS (UNIT 2 CONSTRUCTS)

You may show the Heavy Backpack visual as a prompt for items 5–7.

5. When you do something wrong, do you know how to say sorry in a way that really means it?	☐	☐	☐
6. After you make a mistake and say sorry, can you feel okay again — instead of still feeling bad about it for a long time?	☐	☐	☐
7. Do you know what it means to 'put down' something heavy you've been carrying inside?	☐	☐	☐
8. Do you know how to be kind to yourself when something goes wrong — the way you'd be kind to a friend?	☐	☐	☐

PART 3 — EMPATHY & FORGIVING OTHERS (UNIT 3 CONSTRUCTS)

9. Do you know why people sometimes hurt other people's feelings, even when they don't mean to?	☐	☐	☐
10. Do you know that forgiving someone doesn't mean you have to be best friends with them again?	☐	☐	☐
11. When someone hurts your feelings, can you try to think about what they might have been feeling too?	☐	☐	☐
12. Do you know it's okay for forgiveness to take time — you don't have to feel okay right away?	☐	☐	☐

PART 4 — GRACE & GENEROSITY (UNIT 4 CONSTRUCTS)

13. Do you know what grace means — being kind to someone even when you don't have to be?	☐	☐	☐
14. Can you think of one small kind thing you could do today for someone who needs it?	☐	☐	☐
15. Do you know that being kind to someone who is hard to be kind to is a choice — and a brave one?	☐	☐	☐
16. Do you feel like this has been a class where people are kind to each other?	☐	☐	☐

PART 5 — OPEN RESPONSE PROMPTS

Ask two or three of these orally, depending on time. Record the child's response in the anecdotal notes column.

Tell me something you know about yourself that not everyone knows.

What do you do when you make a mistake?

What does 'forgiving someone' mean to you?

What is one kind thing you could do for someone in your class this week?

What is something you've gotten better at this year?

SCORING & INTERPRETATION

FOR TEACHER USE ONLY

Scoring: Count A Lot = 2, A Little = 1, Not Really = 0. Maximum score = 32. Pre and post scores are compared at the individual and class level. Class-level: Items where 50% or more of students score 0 at post-assessment identify areas for reinforcement in Year 2. Individual flagging: Children who score 0 on all Unit 2 items at post-assessment may benefit from counselor awareness. This is a conversation-starting signal, not a diagnostic tool. What this instrument is not: This is an unvalidated oral protocol measuring teacher-reported perception of student understanding. Do not use for placement, referral, or any high-stakes purpose. Do not report scores to families as clinical evidence of growth.

3.A2

INSTRUMENT E — TEACHER FIDELITY OBSERVATION CHECKLIST

All Grade Bands · Used by Building Principals, Instructional Coaches, Curriculum Directors

▲ AI INSTRUMENT DISCLOSURE

This instrument was developed by large language models (LLMs) at the recommendation of an AI-generated curriculum review panel. No licensed psychometricians, clinical professionals, or educational measurement specialists participated in instrument design. This is an unvalidated working-draft tool for the pilot year. Do not use for high-stakes decisions — including teacher performance evaluation, student placement, referral, or public claims of programme efficacy — without independent professional review by a qualified educational measurement specialist.

PURPOSE: Instrument E provides a structured observation protocol for administrators conducting informal walk-throughs and formal fidelity observations. Use at least once per semester per delivering teacher. First observation window: Weeks 3–5 of Unit 1 (informal). Second observation window: Weeks 3–5 of Unit 3 (formal).

ARCHITECTURE OF GRACE — TEACHER FIDELITY OBSERVATION CHECKLIST

Observer: _____ Teacher: _____ Date: _____ Unit/
 Lesson: _____ Grade Band: _____

LESSON STRUCTURE & SEQUENCE

Lesson follows the stated unit sequence — not skipped or reordered	☐	☐
Opening ritual/hook is present and predictable before content begins	☐	☐
Students have journals and are using them independently	☐	☐
Grade-level differentiation is visible (appropriate band pacing and scaffolding)	☐	☐
Lesson concludes with a structured exit ticket	☐	☐

VOCABULARY & CURRICULUM LANGUAGE

Teacher uses curriculum vocabulary naturally (grade-appropriate: e.g., Oops vs. Forever / shame vs. guilt / internal critic / impact vs. intent / grace gap)	☐	☐
Key vocabulary is visible in the classroom during the lesson	☐	☐

EMOTIONAL CLIMATE & HOLDING

Students appear physically settled and emotionally present at lesson start	☐	☐
Teacher maintains non-anxious presence — neither dismissive of emotion nor destabilised by it	☐	☐
Discussion participation is voluntary — no student is pressured to share	☐	☐
Teacher responds to emotional moments without shutting them down or amplifying them	☐	☐

DISCLOSURE PROTOCOL READINESS

Teacher knows the disclosure protocol (can describe the 4 types and 6-step response if asked)	☐	☐
School counselor is aware of today's lesson content	☐	☐
For high-risk lessons (as designated ★★ in each book): counselor is present or immediately available	☐	☐

EQUITY & ACCESSIBILITY

Multiple engagement modalities are available (writing, drawing, partner discussion, verbal response)	☐	☐
ELL scaffolding materials are present for students who need them	☐	☐
IEP/504 accommodations are in evidence for students with documented plans	☐	☐
No student is pressured toward forgiveness or emotional disclosure	☐	☐
Culturally responsive delivery is evident — not a one-size framing of constructs	☐	☐

FAMILY ENGAGEMENT

Family Connection prompts are being sent home at unit transitions	☐	☐
Year-start PPRA notification letter was distributed at least 10 days before Lesson 1	☐	☐

OVERALL FIDELITY RATING

☐ Strong (90%+ of items present) — Curriculum delivered with high fidelity. ☐ Developing (70–89% of items present) — One targeted follow-up conversation recommended. ☐ Needs Support (below 70%) — Schedule a direct conversation; consider mid-year coaching session. Observer Notes / Follow-up Actions:

3.A3**INSTRUMENT G — FAMILY ENGAGEMENT SURVEY**

Grades K–2 · Distributed at End of Unit 2 (Mid-Year) and End of Unit 4 (Year-End) · Anonymous

▲ AI INSTRUMENT DISCLOSURE

This instrument was developed by large language models (LLMs) at the recommendation of an AI-generated curriculum review panel. No licensed psychometricians, clinical professionals, or educational measurement specialists participated in instrument design. This is an unvalidated working-draft tool for the pilot year. Do not use for high-stakes decisions — including teacher performance evaluation, student placement, referral, or public claims of programme efficacy — without independent professional review by a qualified educational measurement specialist.

PURPOSE: Instrument G captures anonymous family perception at two points in the year — after Unit 2, when the self-compassion and internal critic work has been delivered, and at year-end. Results are shared with delivering teachers before the mid-year coaching session and used to improve second-half delivery and Year 2 implementation.

ARCHITECTURE OF GRACE — FAMILY ENGAGEMENT SURVEY

School: _____ Grade Band: _____ Distribution: ☐ Mid-Year (after Unit 2) ☐ Year-End (after Unit 4) Date: _____ This survey is anonymous. Please do not write your name or your child's name.

PART 1 — PROGRAM AWARENESS & COMMUNICATION

I have received clear information about the Architecture of Grace curriculum at my child's school.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I understand the goals of the curriculum and what my child is learning.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I know how to opt my child out of any specific lesson if I wish to.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I feel my voice as a parent/guardian is welcomed by the school regarding this curriculum.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FOUNDATION (K-2)

PART 2 — OBSERVED CHILD IMPACT

My child has talked at home about something they learned in this class.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I have noticed my child using language or skills from this class outside of school (e.g., naming feelings, taking ownership, repairing).	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child seems more able to handle mistakes without becoming destabilized.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child has demonstrated more self-compassion or self-kindness this year.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

PART 3 — FREQUENCY & ENGAGEMENT

How often has your child discussed SEL class at home?	☐	☐	☐	☐
How often have you used the optional Family Connection prompts sent home?	☐	☐	☐	☐

PART 4 — OPEN RESPONSE (OPTIONAL)

Is there anything about this curriculum you would like the school to know — a concern, a positive observation, or a question?

Results from this survey are compiled anonymously and shared with delivering teachers before the mid-year coaching session and at year-end. Individual responses are never attributed. Results are used for programme improvement only — not for teacher evaluation.

3.A4

INSTRUMENT H — PILOT YEAR DATA PROTOCOL

For District Assessment Coordinators · All Grade Bands · Pilot Year

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FOUNDATION (K-2)

PURPOSE: Instrument H is the district-level guide to collecting, storing, analyzing, and (optionally) submitting data from the Architecture of Grace pilot year. It covers the full collection timeline, FERPA and mandatory reporting compliance, effect size benchmarks, equity analysis guidance, and recommended validated supplementary instruments for districts that wish to build a more rigorous evidence base.

▲ SCOPE OF THIS PROTOCOL

The pre/post student surveys are original, unvalidated instruments measuring self-reported perception. They are appropriate for programme-level reflection and improvement. They are not appropriate for high-stakes claims about student outcomes, teacher effectiveness, or programme efficacy without additional validation by a qualified educational measurement specialist.

SECTION 1 — DATA COLLECTION TIMELINE

Week 1 of school (before U1L1)	Grade-appropriate pre-assessment	Classroom teacher. Store by Student ID code only — never by name.
End of Unit 2 (mid-year)	Family Engagement Survey	Distributed by teacher. Returned to building administrator. Anonymous.
September / January / May–June	Administrator Monitoring Protocol	Building principal or district coordinator. Three checkpoints.
Once per semester per teacher	Fidelity Observation Checklist	Instructional coach or building principal during lesson observation.
Final week (after U4L7)	Grade-appropriate post-assessment	Same classroom teacher. Return pre alongside post for student self-comparison.
End of Unit 4 (year-end)	Family Engagement Survey	Distributed by teacher. Anonymous.
After post-assessment is collected	Calculate gain scores & complete pilot data summary	District Assessment Coordinator. Aggregate by grade band — no individual student data.
Optional — June deadline	Submit aggregate anonymised data to School of Life Foundation	Voluntary. Contributes to ESSA Tier 2 evidence base. No individual data submitted.

SECTION 2 — FERPA & MANDATORY REPORTING COMPLIANCE**FERPA REQUIREMENTS**

Student ID codes: Match pre and post assessments by a de-identified Student ID code — never by student name. The key connecting ID codes to student names must be stored separately and securely. Storage: All completed assessment instruments stored in a password-protected digital system or locked physical location. Access limited to the classroom teacher and district assessment coordinator. Sharing: No individual student data is shared with parents, other teachers, administrators, or the School of Life Foundation. Only aggregate, anonymised data is compiled for programme review. Year-end disposition: Pre and post assessments are returned to students at year-end, or destroyed securely. They are not retained in the student's permanent academic record. 18-year-old student rights: Under FERPA, students who have turned 18 hold their own educational records rights. For Books 4 and 5, student consent (not parental) is required for any records sharing. This applies to all 9–12 instruments.

SECTION 3 — EFFECT SIZE BENCHMARKS

The following benchmarks are provided for districts that wish to assess whether observed pre/post gains are educationally meaningful. These are guidance values for programme reflection — not performance thresholds.

$d < 0.2$	Negligible	Pre/post change is within normal variation. No strong signal of curriculum impact at the construct level. Review delivery fidelity.
$d \geq 0.2$	Small	Modest signal. Students are moving in the right direction on self-report measures. Consistent with low-intensity SEL exposure.
$d \geq 0.3$	Target threshold	The pilot year target for Architecture of Grace. Consistent with Tier 2 ESSA evidence expectations for SEL programmes.
$d \geq 0.5$	Moderate	Strong signal for a self-report measure. Indicates meaningful programme impact is likely if delivery fidelity is confirmed.
$d \geq 0.8$	Large	Very strong signal. Uncommon in self-report SEL instruments without clinical intervention. Warrants validation with external measure.

Calculating d : $d = (\text{Mean Post} - \text{Mean Pre}) / \text{Pooled Standard Deviation}$. Use the composite score (sum of all items) for the calculation. Calculate separately by grade band — do not combine K–2 and 9–12 data.

SECTION 4 — EQUITY ANALYSIS

Aggregate data alone may mask meaningful disparities. After calculating overall gain scores, disaggregate by the following subgroups where data is available. No student should be identifiable from reported data.

ELL / English Language Learner status	Comparable pre/post gain to non-ELL peers. Lower gain may indicate scaffolding gaps.
Students with IEP / 504 plans	Comparable access and engagement. Lower gain warrants review of accommodation implementation.
Race / Ethnicity	No systematic gap in gain scores by racial/ethnic group. Differential outcomes warrant curriculum equity review.
Grade level (within a band)	Comparable gains across Grades 3/4/5, 6/7/8, or 9/10/11/12. Significant variance by grade may indicate pacing mismatch.
Teacher (where multiple teachers deliver)	Comparable gains across classrooms. Significant variance warrants fidelity review for lower-gain classrooms.

SECTION 5 — RECOMMENDED VALIDATED SUPPLEMENTARY INSTRUMENTS

For districts seeking externally validated measures to supplement the Architecture of Grace pre/post surveys, the following instruments are recommended. These are independent of the School of Life Foundation and require separate licensing.

DESSA-3 (Devereux Student Strengths Assessment)	K-12	Social-emotional competence across 8 subscales. Teacher-rated. ESSA evidence-based. Provides validated external benchmark for self-compassion and relationship skills constructs.
SSIS-SEL (Social Skills Improvement System)	K-12	CASEL-aligned SEL competencies. Both teacher-rated and student self-report versions. Covers all five CASEL domains addressed in this curriculum.
Neff SCS-SF (Self-Compassion Scale – Short Form)	Grades 7-12	Validated 12-item self-report measuring the three components of self-compassion (Neff, 2003). Directly aligned to Unit 2 constructs across all grade bands.
Rosenberg Self-Esteem Scale	Grades 6-12	10-item validated self-report. Not a direct curriculum measure, but provides external validity check on identity and self-worth constructs from Units 1 and 4.
BASC-3 BESS (Behavioral and Emotional Screening System)	K-12	Brief universal screener for behavioural and emotional risk. Can identify students who may need Tier 2 or Tier 3 support beyond this Tier 1 curriculum.

SECTION 6 — VOLUNTARY DATA SUBMISSION TO SCHOOL OF LIFE FOUNDATION

WHAT IS SUBMITTED — AND WHAT IS NOT

Eligible to submit: Aggregate, anonymised pre/post gain score data at the grade-band level. Total N (number of students assessed). Delivery fidelity summary. Family survey aggregate results. No individual student data. No teacher-identified data. Never submitted: Individual student names, ID codes, or scores. Teacher names or classroom-level data. Any data that could identify a student, family, or educator. What submission does: Contributes to the Tier 2 (Moderate Evidence) ESSA pathway for the Architecture of Grace curriculum. Helps the School of Life Foundation improve instruments, implementation support, and equity guidance across the pilot cohort. Submission is voluntary. It has no bearing on continued access to the curriculum, district support, or licensing.

SECTION FOUR

REFERENCE & COMPLIANCE

Materials for occasional reference · Read once · Return when needed

4.1 Framing Essay — The Foundation

WHY WE BEGIN HERE

Children in Grades K–2 do not yet have the abstract reasoning required for sophisticated frameworks of forgiveness or moral discernment. What they DO have — in remarkable supply — is the capacity to name what is real, to feel deeply, and to learn from concrete experience. The Foundation is built on those three capacities.

This curriculum does not teach K–2 children to forgive in the philosophical sense. It teaches them four foundational distinctions that the rest of the Architecture of Grace will rely on for the next decade:

- **Identity is not behaviour.** A mistake is something I did. It is not who I am. This is the most important sentence in the curriculum.
- **Feelings are messengers.** Every feeling carries information. Naming a feeling makes it workable. No feeling is bad.
- **I have an inside voice — and I get to choose which one I listen to.** The Kind Coach helps me grow. The Grumpy Gus tries to make me hide. Both are just thoughts.
- **I can put it down.** When something feels heavy, I can practise setting it down — not forgetting it, just choosing not to carry it the same way today.

WHY SAMMY

Sammy is not a mascot. Sammy is a relational anchor. Young children are extraordinarily sensitive to who is in the room with them when they are asked to do hard emotional work. Adults can be intimidating to defy or disappoint. Peers can be unpredictable. A puppet — visibly held by a trusted adult — occupies a unique psychological space: warm, present, but not threatening.

Sammy holds two voices: Kind Coach and Grumpy Gus. The two-voice structure makes self-talk visible and external before children are asked to recognise it inside themselves. By the time a child can identify their own Grumpy Gus voice, they have heard it modelled, made fun of, and gently corrected dozens of times — always at a safe distance, always in someone else’s mouth first.

Sammy stays in the same physical spot in the room all year. The classroom learns to anticipate Sammy as a regular presence — and the spot becomes a relational anchor. When something hard is being discussed, the children look toward Sammy. The puppet holds the weight that words alone could not carry.

4.2 Quick Start Guide for Administrators

A summary checklist for school and district leaders bringing the Architecture of Grace into their building.

BEFORE THE SCHOOL YEAR BEGINS

- ☐ Distribute PPRA notification to all families at least 10 school days before Lesson 1.
- ☐ Place a physical copy of the full curriculum in the school office for family inspection.
- ☐ Schedule and conduct teacher PD for all delivering teachers before Unit 1 Lesson 1.
- ☐ Brief the school counselor on the Disclosure Protocol and the calendar of ★ / ★★ lessons.
- ☐ Block all counselor-required dates: U2 L4, U2 L5, U2 L6 (★★), U3 L3 (★★), U3 L5 (★), U4 L7 (★).
- ☐ Administer Instrument C (pre-assessment) to all K–2 students before Unit 1 Lesson 1. Store by Student ID code only.
- ☐ Post crisis resource numbers visibly: 988 Lifeline, Crisis Text Line (HOME to 741741).
- ☐ Distribute the Family Grace Audit (Section 4.7.A) to all families with the year-start packet. Coordinate translation through the building’s ELL liaison where feasible.

DURING THE SCHOOL YEAR

- ☐ Conduct Instrument E (Lesson Fidelity Observation) at least once per teacher per semester.
- ☐ Distribute Instrument G (Family Engagement Survey) at end of Unit 2 (mid-year).
- ☐ Conduct Instrument F (Administrator Monitoring) checkpoints in September, January, and May–June.
- ☐ Confirm counselor presence on-site for each ★★ lesson — no exceptions, no substitutes.
- ☐ Track and respond to PPRA opt-out requests within 30 days. Opt-out must be non-punitive.
- ☐ Coordinate with delivering teachers to ensure family communication letters go home at unit transitions.

AFTER UNIT 4 LESSON 7

- ☐ Administer Instrument C (post-assessment) with the same teacher who administered the pre.
- ☐ Distribute end-of-year Instrument G (Family Engagement Survey).

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FOUNDATION (K-2)

- ☐ Aggregate pilot data by grade band only — never individual.
- ☐ Distribute the Final Reflection (Section 4.7.B) and Closing Words to Families (Section 4.7.C) with the year-end packet, after Unit 4 Lesson 7. The audit is private and never collected.
- ☐ Conduct year-end debrief with counselor and delivering teachers. Identify students who may benefit from continued support.
- ☐ Optionally submit aggregated, anonymised data to the School of Life Foundation for pilot reporting.

4.3 Developmental Rationale & CASEL Alignment

WHY K-2 IS THE RIGHT DEVELOPMENTAL WINDOW

Early childhood (ages 5–8) is the developmental period during which children form their earliest internal narratives about themselves — narratives that will be drawn upon, defended, or challenged for the rest of their lives. The capacity to separate identity from behaviour ("I made a mistake" rather than "I am bad") emerges during this window if the cognitive scaffolding is provided. Without that scaffolding, internalised shame can take root and become a default self-perception that requires significant therapeutic work to undo in adolescence and adulthood.

The Foundation does not promise that every K-2 child will fully grasp these distinctions on first contact. It promises that every child will hear the distinctions named, modelled, and practised — dozens of times — in a holding environment that lets them try the ideas on without commitment.

CASEL ALIGNMENT

Self-Awareness	Unit 1 (primary) · All Units (secondary)	Identity Web (U1L1), Feelings as Messengers (U1L2), Mistakes Are Normal (U1L3), Kind Coach vs. Grumpy Gus (U1L4), Oops vs. I Am Bad (U1L5), Growth (U1L6).
Self-Management	Unit 2 (primary) · Unit 1 (secondary)	Real Sorry (U2L3), Self-Compassion (U2L4), Letting Go (U2L5), Self-Forgiveness (U2L6). Sammy puppet models regulated self-talk throughout.
Social Awareness	Unit 3 (primary) · Unit 4 (secondary)	Validating real hurt (U3L1), Why people hurt people (U3L2), Forgiveness vs. Trust (U3L3), Narrative identity (U3L5).
Relationship Skills	Units 3 & 4 (secondary throughout)	Three-part Real Apology (U2L3), Forgiveness vs. Trust (U3L3), I Choose statement (U3L7), Grace with Hard People (U4L5).
Responsible Decision-Making	Unit 4 (primary)	Grace as deliberate choice (U4L1), Mercy (U4L2), Pause Practice and charitable interpretation (U4L3), Community Charter (U4L7).

4.4 Legal & Clinical Compliance

Distribute this section to all delivering teachers before **Unit 1 Lesson 1**.

DISCLOSURE PROTOCOL · APPLIES TO ALL LESSONS

PPRA — Protection of Pupil Rights Amendment Annual notification to families must be distributed a minimum of 10 school days before Lesson 1. A physical copy of this curriculum must be available in the school office for family inspection. Opt-out procedures must be genuinely available and non-punitive at all three tiers (full opt-out, unit opt-out, activity opt-out). PPRA complaints: track, respond within 30 days, document resolution.

DISCLOSURE PROTOCOL · APPLIES TO ALL LESSONS

FERPA — Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act Assessment instruments must be stored by de-identified Student ID code — never by student name. Storage must be a password-protected digital system or a locked physical location. Not accessible to non-administrative staff. No individual student data may be shared with parents, other teachers, or third parties without authorization. Year-end disposition: pre and post assessments returned to students or securely destroyed. Not retained in cumulative files.

★ ★ HIGHEST RISK

MANDATORY REPORTING · 6-STEP DISCLOSURE PROTOCOL **1. STOP the lesson immediately.** 2. Activate your school's mandatory disclosure protocol. 3. Contact the counselor NOW — not after class. Not after the lesson. Now. **4. Do NOT leave the student alone.** 5. Do NOT attempt to assess risk yourself. Do NOT promise confidentiality. 6. Document in writing the same day: what was said, exact words if possible, time, witnesses, actions taken.

CRISIS RESOURCES · POST BEFORE U2 L6

AFSP Safe Messaging Guidelines · Apply to all ★ ★ lessons Do NOT use "committed suicide" — use "died by suicide." Do NOT describe methods, means, or locations. Do NOT present suicide as a solution or romanticise it. DO provide crisis resources visibly. DO focus on help-seeking, resilience, and connection.
988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline · Call or text **988** | **Crisis Text Line** · Text **HOME** to **741741**

GRADE-BAND NOTE · GRADES K-2

Secular Assurance "Forgiveness," "grace," and "mercy" are used in this curriculum as psychological and relational constructs — not theological ones. No religious text, tradition, or practice is referenced, required, or implied. The curriculum is designed to align with secular public education standards in all 50 states. If families raise religious concerns about vocabulary: acknowledge the dual use of these terms, point to the secular framing in the curriculum, and offer the PPRA opt-out process.

4.5 Counselor Integration Calendar

BLOCK THESE DATES ON THE COUNSELOR'S CALENDAR BEFORE UNIT 1 LESSON 1 IS DELIVERED. NO EXCEPTIONS.

U2 L4	Being Kind to Myself	PPRA · Counselor briefed	Brief before delivery
U2 L5	Letting Go — The Practice	PPRA · Counselor briefed	Brief before delivery
U2 L6	When It's Hard to Forgive Yourself	★★ HIGHEST · ON-SITE FULL LESSON	No exceptions
U3 L3	Forgiving Is Not the Same as Trusting	★★ HIGHEST · ON-SITE FULL LESSON	No exceptions
U3 L5	My Story Is Not the Whole Me	★ ELEVATED · Counselor on-site	One-week advance notice
U4 L7	Community Charter & Year-End Celebration	★ ELEVATED · Counselor on standby	Reachable same day

STANDING COORDINATION REQUIREMENTS

Before Unit 1 Lesson 1: Counselor attends teacher PD. Disclosure Protocol reviewed. Communication channel established. Calendar blocked. **Before Unit 2 Lesson 6:** Counselor and teacher review every student's engagement so far. Identify students entering U2 L6 with the highest emotional load. **January mid-year:** Virtual coaching session — counselor attends. Debrief on Semester 1 patterns and prepare for Unit 3 (most disclosure-sensitive unit). **After Unit 4 Lesson 7:** Counselor and teacher year-end debrief. Identify students who may benefit from continued counselor contact.

SEE ALSO

The Family Grace Audit (Section 4.7.A) is distributed to families twice in the school year — at the year-start, alongside the PPRA notification, and at the year-end, alongside the Closing Words. The audit is private; counselors do not collect it and do not ask about its contents. Its purpose is to give families the same vocabulary and reflection structure their child is using in class.

4.6 Inclusive Delivery — IEP / SpEd / ELL

The Architecture of Grace is designed for universal Tier 1 delivery. Drawing is always a full alternative to writing. Verbal response is always optional. Pointing, gesturing, and using a communication device are always valid. The accommodations below extend, rather than replace, the universal design.

IEP / SPED ACCOMMODATIONS

Extended Time	Lessons are 20–25 min with no timed student outputs. Allow additional drawing/response time during exit tickets and drawing activities.
Modified Output	Drawing is ALWAYS a full response. Verbal response to teacher or aide is always accepted. Pointing, gesturing, or using a communication device is always valid.
Preferential Seating	Sammy is always in the same spot — position the student where Sammy is visible. Ensure the student can see anchor charts being built.
Sensory	The stone practice (U2 L5) may need a substitute object for tactile-sensitive students. Movement activities (U1 L2) can be modified to seated movements. Loud vocal exercises can be whispered.
Behavioral Support	The exit ritual is a natural check-in moment. For students with significant behavioral IEPs, coordinate with the counselor before ★ and ★★ lessons.
Communication Devices	Augmentative communication devices are fully compatible. Pre-load relevant vocabulary before ★★ lessons. Allow device use during all partner shares.
Paraprofessional Support	Paras may support scribing, gestural interpretation, and quiet redirects. Brief the paraprofessional before all safety-flagged lessons on the Disclosure Protocol.
Reading Support	No lesson requires student reading. All anchor charts are built collaboratively. Sentence frames are delivered orally and can be pre-printed with visuals.
Counselor Coordination	For students with trauma histories on IEPs: brief the counselor before Unit 2 begins. Ensure the IEP team knows the Disclosure Protocol.

ELL SCAFFOLDING

A complete five-component scaffolding guide for ELL students is built into every lesson, covering: Core Vocabulary, Academic Language Pre-Teaching, Visual Supports, Culturally Responsive Delivery, Sentence Frames, and Pacing Notes. Drawing is always a full alternative to writing. Home-language labelling is always permitted. The following principles apply universally:

Visuals before vocabulary. Anchor charts are built with icons before words. Sammy models behaviour before any abstract concept is named. Most concepts are introduced kinesthetically before they are named in English.

Drawing is always primary. Every drawing activity in the curriculum is genuinely accessible without English. The visual examples are teacher references, not student requirements.

Sentence frames at every output. Every K–2 lesson includes specific sentence frames for ELL students. Use them. They reduce blank-page anxiety and let the language carry the cognitive work.

Cultural framings, not cultural assumptions. Self-compassion, forgiveness, and grace are cross-cultural concepts — but their expression varies. Honor home-language and home-culture framings. The curriculum's vocabulary is one access point, not the only one.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FOUNDATION (K-2)

Privacy is a stronger affordance than disclosure. For students from high-shame-context families or trauma backgrounds, the private nature of drawings and journal pages is the most powerful accommodation in the curriculum.

4.7 Family Engagement Materials

Four letters to send home at unit transitions. Translate into home languages where feasible. Keep a distribution record for PPRA compliance.

LETTER 1 · YEAR-START · PPRA NOTIFICATION

Distribute minimum 10 school days before Lesson 1

Dear Families,

This year, your child will participate in the Architecture of Grace — a social-emotional learning curriculum designed to help young people develop self-awareness, self-compassion, empathy, and the capacity to give and receive grace.

The curriculum covers four units across the school year: Knowing & Accepting Yourself (Aug–Oct), Self-Compassion & Self-Forgiveness (Oct–Dec), Empathy & Forgiving Others (Jan–Mar), and Grace & Generosity (Apr–Jun).

This is not a religious curriculum. The words "forgiveness," "grace," and "mercy" are used here as psychological and relational concepts — not theological ones.

Your child's participation is voluntary. If you wish to opt out of specific activities or the full curriculum, please contact the school office. Opt-out is always non-punitive.

A copy of the full curriculum is available for review in the school office. Please contact us with any questions.

Sincerely,

[Teacher Name]

LETTER 2 · END OF UNIT 1 · TRANSITION TO UNIT 2

Distribute at the close of Unit 1

Dear Families,

Your child has completed Unit 1 — Knowing & Accepting Yourself. They have learned that everyone makes mistakes, that all feelings are messengers, that they have an inside voice that can be kind or unkind, and that they are growing.

Next, in Unit 2 — Self-Compassion & Self-Forgiveness — your child will learn what real apology sounds like, how to be kind to themselves when they make mistakes, and how to put down the heavy feelings they carry.

You can support this work at home in two simple ways: when your child is hard on themselves, ask them gently — "Was that your Kind Coach or your Grumpy Gus?" And when YOU make a mistake, model audibly: "I made a mistake — it is okay — I will try again." Modelling is the most powerful teaching at this age.

Thank you for your partnership.

Sincerely,

[Teacher Name]

LETTER 3 · END OF UNIT 2 · MID-YEAR

Distribute at the end of Unit 2 along with Family Engagement Survey (Instrument G)

Dear Families,

We have reached the mid-year point of Architecture of Grace. Your child has finished Unit 2 — the most internally focused unit of the year. They have learned the three parts of a real apology, the three parts of being kind to themselves, and the practice of putting something down.

In Unit 3 — Empathy & Forgiving Others — we shift outward. Your child will learn that real hurt deserves to be named, that forgiveness is for THEIR peace (not the other person's), and that forgiveness is NOT the same as trusting again. We will also explicitly affirm that nobody is required to forgive someone who is currently still hurting them.

A Family Engagement Survey is enclosed. Your responses are anonymous and help us improve the curriculum. We are grateful for your time.

Sincerely,

[Teacher Name]

LETTER 4 · END OF UNIT 4 · YEAR-END

*Distribute after **Unit 4 Lesson 7*

Dear Families,

Architecture of Grace, Book One, is complete. Your child has spent a full school year practising self-compassion, learning to forgive themselves and others, and building the daily habit of giving grace.

They will not have mastered any of these skills — nobody does in one year. What they have done is hear, see, and practise the foundational distinctions of the curriculum dozens of times in a holding environment. The work continues in Book Two next year.

A year-end Family Engagement Survey is enclosed. Your honest feedback shapes the next pilot year and the next group of children.

Thank you for trusting us with the work of your child's heart this year.

Enclosed with this letter is the year-end Family Grace Audit and a short Final Reflection — three questions to sit with as a family before the year is fully behind you. The audit is private. We do not collect it. It is for you.

With gratitude,

[Teacher Name]

4.7.A

THE FAMILY GRACE AUDIT

A private family self-reflection tool — K-2 Edition. Not a test, not a judgment, not something anyone else will see. Complete it once at the start of the school year, once at the end. The comparison is the insight.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FOUNDATION (K-2)

TEACHER NOTE · HOW TO DISTRIBUTE THIS AUDIT

Print sections 4.7.A through 4.7.C as a single packet (the Audit, the Final Reflection, and the Closing Words to Families). Send the packet home twice in the school year: • **Year-Start:** with Letter 1 (Section 4.7, PPRA Notification), at least 10 calendar days before Lesson 1. Families complete Parts 1, 2, and 3. • **Year-End:** with Letter 4 (Section 4.7, year-end letter), after Unit 4 Lesson 7. Families complete Part 4 and the Final Reflection. **Do not collect.** The audit is private. Never ask a family if they completed it. Never ask what they wrote. If a family asks for a fresh copy, give one without comment. The audit is for them, not for you. **Translate where feasible.** For families whose home language is not English, this audit lands far harder in the home language. Coordinate with the building's ELL liaison.

HOW TO USE THIS AUDIT

This audit is for grown-ups in the home. Your child does not need to fill it out with you. It is a quiet, honest look at the grace practices already living in your house — and an honest look at where there is room to grow. Many of the words below come straight from your child's classroom: "Sammy," "Kind Coach," "Grumpy Gus," "Oops," "Mistake Wall." Use them at home. Shared language is what turns a classroom curriculum into a family practice. Take fifteen minutes. Be honest. No one but your family will ever read this.

RECORD

(OPTIONAL)

START OF YEAR

END OF YEAR

K · 1 · 2

PART 1 · THE GRACE CLIMATE IN OUR HOME

Rate your household honestly on each item below. Check the number that fits best. 1 = not yet / rarely · 5 = consistently / naturally.

OOPS & MISTAKE RECOVERY

When someone in our family makes a mistake, we call it an Oops — not a sign that the person is bad.

1	2	3	4	5
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

We talk about the difference between "you did something wrong" and "you ARE bad." In our house, those are not the same thing.

1	2	3	4	5
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FOUNDATION (K-2)

Grown-ups in our home say “I made a mistake — it is okay — I will try again” out loud, where the children can hear it.

1	2	3	4	5
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

THE INSIDE VOICE · KIND COACH OR GRUMPY GUS

When our child is hard on themselves, we ask gently: “Was that your Kind Coach or your Grumpy Gus?”

1	2	3	4	5
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

We notice when WE are talking to ourselves like Grumpy Gus — and we name it out loud.

1	2	3	4	5
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Our child has heard a grown-up in the home use the Kind Coach voice on themselves.

1	2	3	4	5
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

FEELINGS ARE FRIENDS

We make space for big feelings before we try to fix them or make them go away.

1	2	3	4	5
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

We do not say things like “don’t be sad” or “it’s not a big deal” when feelings show up.

1	2	3	4	5
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Our child knows that all feelings — happy, sad, mad, scared — are okay to have, and okay to name.

1	2	3	4	5
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

SAYING SORRY · AND MEANING IT

When someone in our family says a real sorry, we let them finish, and we let it land.

1	2	3	4	5
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

We do not bring up old Oopses again later, like ammunition. When something is finished, it is finished.

1	2	3	4	5
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

We talk about forgiveness as something we do for OURSELVES — not just for the other person.

1	2	3	4	5
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

GRACE WHEN IT IS HARD

When our days are stressful or rushed, we still treat each other with kindness.

1	2	3	4	5
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FOUNDATION (K-2)

We give grace to people outside our family, too — the cashier, the neighbour, the cousin who is hard to like. The children see this.

1	2	3	4	5
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

We notice and name small acts of grace out loud when we see them, the way Sammy would notice.

1	2	3	4	5
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

PART 2 · REFLECTION QUESTIONS

These questions are not scored. Write freely — or talk through them together at the kitchen table. There are no right answers, and no one is grading.

WHERE DOES GRACE ALREADY SHOW UP MOST NATURALLY IN OUR HOME? WHAT DOES IT LOOK LIKE, IN A REAL MOMENT FROM THIS PAST MONTH?

WHERE DOES GRACE USUALLY BREAK DOWN IN OUR FAMILY? WHAT SEEMS TO SET IT OFF — TIME OF DAY, CERTAIN TOPICS, CERTAIN PEOPLE, BEING TIRED?

WHAT IS ONE THING WE WANT OUR K-2 CHILD TO CARRY FORWARD ABOUT GRACE, FORGIVENESS, OR BEING KIND TO THEMSELVES — FROM THIS YEAR, INTO THE REST OF THEIR LIFE?

IS THERE SOMEONE IN OUR FAMILY'S STORY — PAST OR PRESENT — WHO IS HARD FOR US TO EXTEND GRACE TO? YOU DON'T HAVE TO WRITE THE NAME. JUST NOTICE WHETHER THEY ARE THERE.

PART 3 · FAMILY COMMITMENTS

Choose one or two things your family wants to practise this year. These are not assignments. They are intentions — written in your own words, in your own voice.

WE COMMIT TO—

WE COMMIT TO—

FOR EXAMPLE: "WAS THAT YOUR KIND COACH OR YOUR GRUMPY GUS?" OR "IT IS OKAY — YOU HAD AN OOPS. LET'S FIX IT." OR "YOUR FEELINGS MAKE SENSE."

FOR EXAMPLE: BRINGING UP OLD OOPSES, SAYING "DON'T CRY," SAYING "JUST GET OVER IT," OR NAMING A CHILD BY THE WORST THING THEY HAVE DONE.

PART 4 · END-OF-YEAR REVIEW

Complete this section after Lesson 7 of Unit 4 — the year-end celebration. Compare your answers to Parts 1 and 2. The gap between them is your family's growth story.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FOUNDATION (K-2)

WHAT SHIFTED IN OUR HOME THIS YEAR — EVEN SLIGHTLY — AROUND GRACE, FORGIVENESS, OR BEING KIND TO OURSELVES?

WAS THERE A MOMENT THIS YEAR WHEN SOMEONE IN OUR FAMILY CHOSE GRACE WHEN THEY DIDN'T HAVE TO? WHAT HAPPENED? TELL THE STORY IN THREE SENTENCES.

RETURN TO PART 1. RE-RATE EACH ITEM WITHOUT LOOKING AT YOUR ORIGINAL ANSWERS FIRST. THEN COMPARE. WHERE DID WE GROW? WHERE ARE WE STILL WORKING?

ONE THING OUR FAMILY WILL KEEP PRACTISING INTO NEXT YEAR, INTO BOOK TWO, INTO THE REST OF THEIR CHILDHOOD.

PRIVATE · KEEP IT IN THE HOUSE

This audit belongs to your family. The school does not collect it. The teacher does not ask about it. No one ever sees it but you. Keep it somewhere you can find it again — a kitchen drawer, the inside cover of a book — and return to it. School of Life Foundation · Architecture of Grace · Grades K-2.

4.7.B

THE FAMILY GRACE AUDIT — FINAL REFLECTION

As Book One closes — after the Year-End Celebration in Unit 4, Lesson 7 — sit down as a family and answer these three questions. You do not need a therapist. You do not need a curriculum. You need an honest conversation and thirty minutes.

WHAT HEAVY THING DID WE HELP EACH OTHER PUT DOWN THIS YEAR? IN UNIT 2, THE CHILDREN LEARNED THAT SOME FEELINGS GET HEAVY IF WE CARRY THEM TOO LONG. WHAT WEIGHT DID WE CARRY TOGETHER AS A FAMILY — AND PUT DOWN TOGETHER?

WHEN WAS A TIME SOMEONE IN OUR FAMILY GAVE GRACE WHEN THEY DIDN'T HAVE TO? INSIDE OUR HOME, OR OUT IN THE WORLD? EVEN A SMALL MOMENT COUNTS. ESPECIALLY A SMALL ONE.

IS THERE A PATTERN — OF SHAME, OF YELLING, OF HOLDING GRUDGES, OF PERFECTIONISM — THAT WE ARE CHOOSING TO END WITH THIS GENERATION? NAME IT. THEN DECIDE TOGETHER: IS THIS WHERE IT STOPS?

4.7.C

CLOSING WORDS TO FAMILIES

Reproduce on letterhead and send home with the year-end materials, or read aloud at the Year-End Celebration.

Every lesson, every Sammy story, every “Oops — I will fix it — I will try again” your child has practised this year has added a stone to something being built inside them. They leave Book One with something most adults were never handed at this age: a language for grace, and a small, working framework for living it.

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They will not do it perfectly. Neither will you. Neither will any of us. But they have been given the radical idea — early, while it can still take root — that people are more than their worst moments. That a mistake is an Oops, not an identity. That the voice in their head can be a Kind Coach, not a Grumpy Gus.

That foundation matters. The work you do at home — around the dinner table, in the car, in the long quiet of ordinary evenings — is where it gets built into them for keeps. You are the primary architect of your child's heart. The classroom is a partner. You are the foundation.

THE LAST STONE IS NOT THE END · IT IS THE FOUNDATION FOR WHAT COMES NEXT

Thank you for trusting us with the work of your child's heart this year. Book Two awaits in Grades 3–5. Go build something worth living in.

4.7.D

ADMINISTRATIVE FORMS · MASTER SET

PPRA Parental Notification · Student Opt-Out Request · District Implementation Checklist · K–2 Edition. Reproduce freely on school letterhead. All three documents must be on file before instruction begins in any federally funded school.

APPENDIX A — PPRA PARENTAL NOTIFICATION LETTER

Reproduce on school letterhead. Mail or email to all families at least 10 calendar days before the first lesson. PPRA-compliant — K–2 edition. (See also Letter 1 in Section 4.7 above; this version is the formal compliance letter, distributed alongside the warmer family-facing letter.)

Date: _____

To: Parent / Guardian of: _____

From: _____

RE: NOTICE OF SUPPLEMENTAL CURRICULUM — ARCHITECTURE OF GRACE, BOOK ONE, GRADES K-2

Dear Parent or Guardian,

Our school will soon begin the Architecture of Grace social-emotional learning curriculum for Grades K–2. To comply with the Protection of Pupil Rights Amendment (PPRA, 20 U.S.C. § 1232h), we are notifying you in advance that this curriculum includes activities that invite young students to explore personal feelings and emotional responses through age-appropriate puppet work, drawing, and discussion.

PPRA-DESIGNATED ACTIVITIES IN BOOK ONE · K-2

The following activities are specifically designated as PPRA-triggering because they invite age-appropriate self-reflection on internal emotional content:

- The Identity Web Drawing (Unit 1, Lesson 1) — students draw a small private picture of who they are.

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- The Kind Coach / Grumpy Gus Framework (Unit 1, Lesson 4) — students notice and name their own self-talk through Sammy's two voices.
- The Being Kind to Myself Drawing (Unit 2, Lesson 4) — students reflect privately on a recent Oops and what kind words they would say to themselves.
- Letting Go — The Practice (Unit 2, Lesson 5) — students name something they would like to put down, drawn privately, never collected.
- Forgiveness Stories (Unit 3, Lesson 6) — students hear and respond to age-appropriate stories about forgiving others.

YOUR RIGHTS UNDER PPRA

- You have the right to inspect curriculum materials before they are taught. A physical copy of Book One is available in the school office.
- You have the right to opt your child out of specific activities or the full program. No academic penalty will result.
- To exercise opt-out rights, complete the Opt-Out Request Form (Appendix B) and return it to the school office.

If you have questions, please contact:

School Counselor: _____

Principal / Administrator: _____

Phone / Email: _____

PPRA NOTICE • K-2 EDITION

This notice is required under federal law for all schools receiving federal funding. Retain a copy of this letter and all returned Opt-Out Forms in the school's administrative records.

APPENDIX B — STUDENT OPT-OUT REQUEST FORM

Complete and return to the school office. Do not submit to the classroom teacher. A copy will be filed in the school's administrative records — not in the student's academic file. K-2 Edition.

Student Name: _____

Grade • Teacher: _____

Date of Request: _____

OPT-OUT TYPE • SELECT ONE

- ☐ **TIER 1 — Curricular Inquiry Only.** I would like to review curriculum materials before making an opt-out decision. Please contact me to arrange access.
- ☐ **TIER 2 — Selective Activity Opt-Out.** I am opting my child out of the following specific activities (list below). My child will remain in the classroom and receive an alternative activity during opted-out segments.

Activities opted out of: _____

(continued): _____

UNIT 4 • LESSON 7 • THE FOUNDATION (K-2)

☐ **TIER 3 — Full Program Opt-Out.** I am opting my child out of the entire Architecture of Grace SEL curriculum for this school year. I understand my child will be relocated to a supervised alternative setting during the SEL block and will receive independent reading or school-approved character-development materials. No academic penalty will result.

ALTERNATIVE PLACEMENT • TIER 2 OR 3 ONLY

- ☐ Library
- ☐ Counselor's office
- ☐ Designated alternative classroom

Parent / Guardian Printed Name: _____

Parent / Guardian Signature • Date: _____

Phone / Email for Follow-Up: _____

FOR OFFICE USE ONLY

Received by • Date Received: _____

Alternative placement arranged: _____

Copy filed in administrative records • Initials: _____

APPENDIX C — DISTRICT IMPLEMENTATION CHECKLIST

To be completed and signed by the designated district administrator before instruction begins. Retain in the district's curriculum adoption file. This checklist constitutes documented evidence of compliance review for the K-2 edition.

District Name: _____

School Name: _____

Grade Level • Academic Year: _____

Designated Administrator: _____

PRE-IMPLEMENTATION COMPLIANCE ITEMS

- ☐ **PPRA Notice.** Parental notification letter (Appendix A) mailed or emailed to all families at least 10 calendar days prior to first lesson.
- ☐ **Curriculum Inspection.** Physical copy of Book One available in the school front office for parental review throughout the school year.
- ☐ **Clinical Review.** School Psychologist or Counselor has reviewed Units 2 and 3 in full and confirmed clinical readiness in writing — with particular attention to Unit 2 Lesson 6 (Highest Risk) and Unit 3 Lesson 3 (Highest Risk).
- ☐ **Sammy Ritual Training.** All delivering teachers have practised both Sammy voices (Kind Coach and Grumpy Gus) and have committed to the year-start Sammy Ritual described in Section 1.5.

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- ☐ **Disclosure Protocol Training.** All delivering teachers have completed the 6-step Disclosure Protocol training in the Teacher PD module (Section 5.4) and acknowledged the Type 4 mandatory reporting threshold.
- ☐ **Re-Entry Protocol.** School Counselor and classroom teachers have reviewed and acknowledged the Post-Disclosure Re-Entry Protocol.
- ☐ **Drawing Privacy.** The No-Collection rule for student drawings has been communicated in classroom procedures and acknowledged by teachers in writing.
- ☐ **Opt-Out Process.** Opt-Out Request Form (Appendix B) is available in the school office and designated staff are trained to receive and process requests.
- ☐ **Legal Review.** District legal counsel or designated administrator has reviewed Section 4.5 (Legal & Clinical Compliance) and confirmed adoption readiness.
- ☐ **Board Documentation.** The secular nature of the curriculum was explicitly considered and documented at the time of board adoption.

ADMINISTRATOR CERTIFICATION

I certify that the above compliance items have been completed prior to the delivery of the Architecture of Grace, Book One, K-2 curriculum in our school / district.

Administrator Signature: _____

Printed Name and Title: _____

Date: _____

DISTRICT FILE · K-2 COMPLIANCE EDITION

School of Life Foundation · Architecture of Grace · Book One: The Foundation · Grades K-2 · Legal & Clinical Compliance Edition. This document is provided for administrative use. Consult your district's legal counsel with jurisdiction-specific compliance questions.

4.8 Curriculum Vocabulary Glossary

Key terms used throughout the Architecture of Grace, defined as they apply to this curriculum.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FOUNDATION (K-2)

Anchor Chart	A large visual built WITH students on the day indicated and posted permanently in the classroom for the rest of the year. Anchor charts are the visible memory of what was learned together.
Architecture of Grace	The full curriculum, comprising four books across grade bands K-2 (The Foundation), 3-5 (Heavy Backpack), 6-8 (The Interior), and 9-12 (forthcoming). Book One: The Foundation is the K-2 entry point.
Disclosure Protocol	The 6-step response when a student discloses harm: STOP, activate school protocol, contact counselor NOW, do not leave the student alone, do not assess risk yourself, document the same day. See Section 4.4.
Drawing Activity	A teacher-directed art activity that creates an artefact of internal work. Drawings are always private — never collected or displayed unless the student offers them.
Family Connection	A short note home included with every lesson. Sent only with educator review. Designed to extend the lesson's work into the home without requiring family follow-through.
Forgiveness	In this curriculum: the choice to release the inner weight of a hurt for one's own peace. NOT the same as forgetting, saying-it-was-okay, or trusting again. Used as a psychological/relational concept, not a theological one.
Forgiveness Path	The non-linear progression toward letting go of a hurt: still hurting → starting to understand → some days are better → putting it down today → the hurt is getting smaller → I am okay. Setbacks are normal. Wherever a student is on the path is okay.
Future-Self Letter	A sealed letter written in U2 L7 and opened in U4 L7. Provides longitudinal evidence of growth and serves as an anchor across the school year.
Grace	In this curriculum: the choice to extend kindness, patience, or a second chance to someone who has not earned it. Grace is a CHOICE — not a rule. Grace has limits set by safety and dignity.
Grace vs. Doormat	The distinction between chosen kindness (grace) and unchosen kindness (being walked on). The difference is agency. A doormat has no choice. Grace has a choice.
Grumpy Gus	The unkind inside voice. Sharper, theatrical, never frightening. Attacks identity ("You ARE bad") rather than behaviour. Externalising the inner critic as a puppet voice makes it visible and workable.
In-Lesson Scan	An inline observational prompt placed at the precise activity it monitors. Watch for named behaviours. Note privately. Do not address publicly.
Kind Coach	The kind inside voice. Warm, gentle, helpful. Asks "What happened? What can I learn? What is one next step?" The voice the curriculum teaches every child to recognise and choose.
Mercy	The choice to lessen a consequence someone HAS earned. Distinct from grace (which gives unearned generosity). Mercy is wise when the person is learning and safety is intact.
Oops vs. "I Am Bad"	The foundational distinction of the curriculum. An Oops is something you DID (a behaviour). "I am bad" is about who you ARE (an identity). One can be fixed; the other is never true.

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Pause Practice	The four-step charitable interpretation tool (U4 L3): (1) Something ambiguous happens. (2) Notice your first thought. (3) Pause and ask "Is there another way to see this — a kind one?" (4) Act on the kind story.
PPRA	Protection of Pupil Rights Amendment. Federal law requiring parental notification before SEL curricula and providing opt-out rights. Two lessons (U2 L4, U2 L5) are explicitly PPRA-designated in this curriculum.
Sammy Ritual	The Year-Start introduction in which Sammy meets each student by name and is placed in his permanent spot for the year. Establishes Sammy as a regular relational presence.
Self-Compassion	The three-part practice from Dr. Kristin Neff's research, adapted for K-2: (1) self-kindness, (2) common humanity, (3) mindfulness. Talk to yourself as you would a good friend.
Sentence Frames	Pre-built sentence starters that scaffold student responses. Used universally, especially for ELL students. Reduces blank-page anxiety and lets the language carry cognitive work.
Support Web	A student-drawn diagram of trusted adults they could turn to when something feels too heavy to carry alone. Built in U2 L6. An empty web is a significant safety signal.
Three-Panel Story	A framing tool from U3 L5: Panel 1 (what happened, always private), Panel 2 (the story I told myself), Panel 3 (who I am now, BIGGER than Panel 1). Helps separate experience from identity.
Three-Part Real Sorry	The structure of a real apology: (1) name what happened, (2) name the hurt, (3) name the change. All three parts matter. Without all three, sorry is words — not repair.
Trust	In this curriculum: a between-people thing that must be EARNED through real change. Distinct from forgiveness (which is internal and can happen alone). Never owed.



ARCHITECTURE OF GRACE — THE FOUNDATION

SCHOOL OF LIFE FOUNDATION · PILOT VERSION

James Anthony Ramsden, Founder

SECTION FIVE

Professional Development

Half-Day Pre-Year Module · Mid-Year 90-Minute Session · Grades K-2

Facilitator Guide for Building Principals, Instructional Coaches, and School Counselors

5.1 Professional Development Overview

Architecture of Grace · The Foundation requires two professional development sessions during the implementation year: a half-day pre-year module before Lesson 1, and a 90-minute mid-year session after Unit 2 closes. Both are structural to the curriculum — not optional add-ons. Teachers carrying K-2 material need a room that holds them the way they are asked to hold their students.

Each session is designed to be delivered by a building principal, instructional coach, or school counselor — not only by the curriculum author. A prepared non-expert can run these days. Everything required is in this section. Read it fully before the session. Deliver it with presence.

TWO-SESSION STRUCTURE

5.2 Half-Day Pre-Year	Establish theoretical foundation, trauma-informed posture, in-the-moment disclosure protocol, live lesson experience, Teacher Reflection habit, shared vocabulary	Before Unit 1 Lesson 1 (August)
5.3 Mid-Year 90 Min	Implementation debrief, disclosure protocol recalibration, teacher wellbeing, preparation for Unit 3's harder content	Within 2 weeks of Unit 2 close (December) · Must precede U3 L3

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FOUNDATION (K-2)

A NOTE ON TONE

Neither session is a compliance check. They are the threshold between teachers reading the curriculum and teachers being able to deliver it with the presence the work requires. Set that tone from the opening.

5.2 Half-Day Pre-Year Module

3 hours 30 minutes (plus optional 30-minute extended Q&A) · Six blocks · Delivered before Lesson 1 of Unit 1

AUDIENCE	Classroom teachers (Grades K-2) who will deliver Architecture of Grace · The Foundation. School counselors and instructional coaches may attend. Administrators are welcome but should participate as learners, not evaluators.
FACILITATOR	Building principal, instructional coach, or counselor. No prior SEL expertise required; preparation and presence are the requirements.
PREPARATION	Read this full PD module at least 48 hours in advance. Read the Teacher Implementation Guide in full. Complete Block 5 (Teacher Reflection) personally before the day — you will model a real response, not a hypothetical one.
MATERIALS	Participant one-pager (5.5 at the end of this section, one per teacher) · Chart paper and markers · Printed or projected slide outline (5.4) · Journal or index cards for Block 5 · Timer visible to facilitator

BLOCK SEQUENCE

1	The Theoretical Framework — Why This Curriculum Exists	45 min
2	Trauma-Informed Delivery — Holding the Room	45 min
3	Disclosure & Distress Protocol Practice	30 min
4	Live Lesson Model — U1 L5 — Oops vs. I Am Bad	45 min
5	Teacher Reflection as Personal Practice	30 min
6	Glossary Orientation & Q&A	15 min

5.2 · BLOCK 1 (45 MINUTES)

BLOCK 1

The Theoretical Framework

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FOUNDATION (K-2)

Facilitator purpose: Teachers must understand the "why" before they can deliver the "what." This block builds the research foundation and establishes that the curriculum is serious work with a serious evidence base — not a feel-good add-on.

SHAME VS. GUILT RESEARCH (15 MIN)

Open with this: "Before we talk about the curriculum, I want to start with a question. Think of the last time you made a mistake at work — something you genuinely regret. Don't share it. Just hold it. Now notice: what are you feeling right now? Is it about what you did, or about who you are?" Allow 60 seconds of silence. Then: "That distinction is the heart of this curriculum."

Present the research base. Brené Brown's decade of grounded theory research established that shame — the belief that "I am bad" — is correlated with depression, anxiety, addiction, aggression, and eating disorders, and is negatively correlated with empathy, courage, and connection. Guilt — the belief that "I did something bad" — is correlated with positive outcomes including repair behavior, accountability, and prosocial action (Brown, 2010; Tangney, Stuewig & Mashek, 2007). This is not intuitive. Many adults operate with the assumption that shame is a useful motivator. The research says the opposite: shame produces hiding, not repair.

Classroom implication. When a teacher says "you should be ashamed of yourself," they are activating a neurological threat response that shuts down the learning brain and produces aggression or withdrawal — not reflection. When a teacher activates the repair pathway instead — using the curriculum's grade-band-appropriate framing — students learn to do the same for themselves. This curriculum teaches children to hold their own mistakes that way. Ask teachers: "What language did the adults in your life use when you made mistakes? How did it land?" Allow 2 minutes of pair-share.

SELF-COMPASSION SCIENCE (15 MIN)

Kristin Neff's foundational work defines self-compassion as composed of three elements: self-kindness (treating oneself with the care one would offer a good friend), common humanity (recognizing that imperfection and suffering are universal human experiences, not personal failures), and mindfulness (holding painful thoughts and feelings in balanced awareness rather than suppressing or over-identifying with them). Self-compassion is not self-esteem. Self-esteem is contingent on performance and comparison; self-compassion is unconditional. Research shows self-compassion is associated with greater emotional resilience, less anxiety and depression, more motivation after failure, and healthier coping behaviors (Neff, 2011).

FACILITATOR NOTE

Many teachers will have a visceral resistance to self-compassion as a concept. They may have been raised to believe that self-criticism is the engine of improvement. Name this directly: "If your instinct is that self-compassion sounds soft or indulgent — that is a normal and common reaction, and the research will surprise you. Self-compassion is associated with higher standards and more persistence after failure, not lower ones. The internal critic does not make us better. It makes us more afraid."

FORGIVENESS EDUCATION RESEARCH BASE (15 MIN)

Robert Enright and Richard Fitzgibbons established the empirical basis for forgiveness as a teachable, developmental skill. Their research across 35 years and multiple populations demonstrates that forgiveness interventions produce measurable reductions in anxiety, depression, and anger, and improvements in hope and self-esteem. Critically, their model defines forgiveness as a gift the forgiver gives themselves — not a transaction, not reconciliation, and not condoning harmful behavior. This distinction is foundational to the curriculum's treatment of forgiveness in Units 2, 3, and 4.

Everett Worthington's REACH model of forgiveness offers a complementary process-oriented framework. Where Enright and Fitzgibbons define the destination of forgiveness, Worthington's REACH model describes the path. The five steps — Recall the hurt without rumination, Empathize with the one who caused it, offer Altruistic gift of forgiveness, Commit to the forgiveness, and Hold onto it against doubt — provide a process map. The model's emphasis on empathy as a bridge to forgiveness (not a requirement for it) is directly consistent with the curriculum's Unit 3 architecture.

REFERENCES FOR FURTHER READING

Brown, B. (2010). *The Gifts of Imperfection*. Hazelden. Tangney, J. P., Stuewig, J., & Mashek, D. J. (2007). Moral emotions and moral behavior. *Annual Review of Psychology*, 58, 345–372. Neff, K. (2011). Self-Compassion: The Proven Power of Being Kind to Yourself. William Morrow. Enright, R., & Fitzgibbons, R. (2015). *Forgiveness Therapy*. American Psychological Association. Worthington, E. L. (2006). *Forgiveness and Reconciliation: Theory and Application*. Routledge.

WHY THIS RESEARCH MATTERS AT GRADES K-2

At K-2, children are learning the difference between "I made a mistake" and "I am bad." This is the foundational developmental work. Brown's research on shame vs. guilt is most consequential at this age — what children learn now about whether mistakes are identity-defining shapes the next decade of their relationship to failure. Sammy the puppet exists because young children process emotional content best when an external character carries it. The puppet is not a gimmick; it is a developmental scaffold.

FACILITATOR CLOSING FOR BLOCK 1

"We are not teaching children to be nice. We are teaching them a set of internal skills that the research says are foundational to mental health, academic engagement, and the capacity to build and repair relationships across a lifetime. That is what you are being asked to deliver. Let's talk about how."

5.2 · BLOCK 2 (45 MINUTES)**BLOCK 2****Trauma-Informed Delivery**

Facilitator purpose: This block addresses the emotional reality of teaching this curriculum. Teachers will face activated students, and they will encounter their own material. Prepare them for both.

WHEN CONTENT ACTIVATES STUDENTS (20 MIN)

This curriculum works with real emotional material. Students will sometimes respond to lessons with unexpected emotion — tears, silence, a sudden need to leave the room, or a disclosure that goes further than the classroom context can safely hold. This is not a failure of the curriculum or the teacher. It is evidence that the curriculum is reaching something real.

Distinguishing productive discomfort from acute distress. Productive discomfort is the feeling of sitting with a hard truth or a new idea. A student who is quiet and thoughtful after a difficult lesson is likely in productive discomfort. This is the learning state. Do not rescue students from it by rushing on. A student who is crying, hyperventilating, dissociating (staring blankly, unresponsive), or who makes a disclosure suggesting active trauma or safety concern is in acute distress. This requires immediate, calm response — not curriculum delivery. Pause. Move toward the student quietly. Use the 6-step disclosure protocol (see Block 3).

Distress in K-2 looks different than at older grades. Young children rarely pass notes or articulate distress in adult language. They may go still, cover their ears, parallel-play through the lesson, or say something striking in passing as a transition. Reading these signals is a developmental skill teachers can build.

FACILITATOR EXERCISE · THREE K-2 SCENARIOS

Present the three student scenarios below. Ask teachers to identify each as productive discomfort or acute distress, and to name their immediate response. The scenarios are calibrated to K-2 developmental reality.

Scenario 1. During the "My Inside Voice" lesson, a student becomes very quiet during the drawing activity. They are not crying, but they have stopped drawing entirely and are staring at the page. When you crouch beside them, they don't look up. **Scenario 2.** During the Sammy story about making a mistake, a student suddenly puts both hands over their ears and says "I don't want to do this anymore." Other students start watching. **Scenario 3.** After the Letting Go practice, a student stays at their desk during transition and tells you very quietly: "My dad doesn't let me say sorry. He says only babies say sorry." Debrief as a group. Identify which scenario(s) require counselor contact within the same day, which require private check-in after class, and which require staying present without intervening.

THE FACILITATOR'S OWN MATERIAL (25 MIN)

Name this directly and early: "Some of you will sit in a lesson about shame and recognize a voice you carry. Some of you will read a self-compassion prompt and realize you have never written one to yourself. Some of you will encounter the forgiveness content and feel something shift — or feel something harden. This is your material. It is not a problem. It is actually a sign that you are the right person to teach this curriculum. But you need to know it's there before you stand in front of your class, not while you're standing there."

Facilitator exercise. Ask teachers to journal privately (not shared) for 5 minutes on this prompt: "Which unit or lesson in this curriculum do you anticipate will be hardest for you to deliver — and why?" After journaling, invite (do not require) 2–3 people to share at the level they are comfortable. Normalize that this curriculum surfaces real things. The Teacher Reflection box in each lesson exists for this reason — it is a private processing tool for the teacher, not a record for anyone else.

KEY MESSAGE

You do not need to be fully healed to teach this curriculum. You need to be aware. Awareness of your own material means you will not project it onto your students, rush past the hard parts, or deliver the lesson from behind a wall of professional distance. Presence — genuine, grounded presence — is the pedagogical method of this curriculum. You cannot fake it. You can practice it.

5.2 · BLOCK 3 (30 MINUTES)**BLOCK 3****Disclosure & Distress Protocol Practice**

Facilitator purpose: Teachers need to practice — not just read — the in-the-moment disclosure response. The role-play scenarios below are calibrated to K-2 developmental reality. They use fictional student names. Do not use names from the curriculum's scenario cards.

THE 6-STEP IN-THE-MOMENT RESPONSE PROTOCOL (10 MIN)

1	Pause and move toward	Stop the lesson. Walk calmly toward the student. Do not draw attention from other students if possible. Give the class independent work: "Keep working in your journal — I'll be right back."
2	Acknowledge without probing	"I can see something is happening for you right now. You don't have to explain it." Do not ask "what's wrong?" — this requires the student to explain while still activated.
3	Offer a choice	"Would you like to step into the hall with me for a minute, or would you like to stay here and just breathe?" Give the student agency. Both choices are valid.
4	Listen and assess	If the student speaks, listen without judgment. Assess: is this a Type 1-3 personal share (emotional but contained) or a Type 4 active safety concern (ongoing harm, suicidal ideation, abuse)? If Type 4: proceed to Step 5 immediately.
5	Connect to counselor (Type 4)	"Thank you for trusting me with this. I want to make sure you have the right support — I'm going to walk you to [counselor's name] right now." Do not promise confidentiality. Do not delay. Contact the counselor immediately.
6	Document and debrief yourself	After class: document what happened in your Teacher Reflection space. Debrief with the counselor or a trusted colleague. You carried something real. Put it down before your next class.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FOUNDATION (K-2)

ROLE-PLAY PRACTICE (20 MIN)

Run two scenarios in pairs. One teacher plays the teacher; one plays the student. Debrief after each. Rotate roles. Use only the fictional names below — do not use names from the curriculum scenario cards. The scenarios are calibrated to K-2 reality.

SCENARIO A · TYPE 2 PERSONAL SHARE (MILD)

During the Unit 2 discussion of what "saying sorry" really means, a 1st grade student named Mateo says quietly, "My grandma made my mom cry on the phone last night and my mom hasn't said sorry yet." The class goes still, and another child whispers, "My mom does that too." **Practice.** How do you acknowledge Mateo without making him the center of attention, validate the second child's whispered share without expanding it, and bring the class back to the lesson without dismissing what just happened? **Debrief.** What did you say first? Did you stay at Mateo's eye level? Did you let the second child's comment sit, or did you redirect? What did Sammy say next?

SCENARIO B · TYPE 4 ACTIVE SAFETY CONCERN (SERIOUS)

A kindergarten student named Lila brings you a drawing during free-choice time. She has drawn a small figure with a large figure standing over it, and she says, "This is when I'm in trouble." When you ask gentle questions, she adds, "He hits me with his belt sometimes." She is calm. **Practice.** Walk through the 6-step protocol live. What do you say first to Lila? How do you protect her dignity in front of the other students? What is the mandated reporting timeline, and what do you say to her about what happens next? **Debrief.** Discuss as full group after both scenarios. Note specifically: K-2 disclosures often come through artwork or as side-comments during routine activities, not in formal share circles. **Key takeaway.** The protocol is the same at every grade. But at K-2, the disclosure may arrive sideways — through a drawing, a phrase whispered during snack, a parallel-play comment to a classmate. Your job is to notice it, take it seriously, and never let it slide because the child seems calm.

5.2 · BLOCK 4 (45 MINUTES)

BLOCK 4

Live Lesson Model — U1 L5 — Oops vs. I Am Bad

Facilitator purpose: Teachers need to experience what this curriculum feels like from the student's seat before they deliver it. **Unit 1 Lesson 5** introduces the foundational guilt-shame distinction at K-2 vocabulary level ("Oops" vs. "I Am Bad"). It is the most concept-dense lesson in Unit 1 and is the clearest demonstration of how Sammy the puppet carries this curriculum's hardest content for young learners. Teachers must experience the puppet pacing from the student seat.

SETUP (5 MIN)

Announce: "For the next 35 minutes, you are a 1st grader in this classroom. I am going to deliver this lesson to you. After we finish, we will debrief together as teachers. Your job right now is not to evaluate the lesson — it is to be in it. Notice what you feel, what questions arise, and what you want to know that the lesson doesn't answer."

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FOUNDATION (K-2)

DELIVER U1 L5 IN FULL (35 MIN)

Use the lesson plan from Section 2 (The Lessons) — Oops vs. I Am Bad of this master document. Deliver at Grade 1 level. Use Sammy the puppet exactly as the lesson script directs. Include the sorting card activity, the Sammy back-and-forth between Kind Coach and Grumpy Gus voices, and the closing sentence frame. The facilitator should deliver this with genuine presence — not as a demonstration of “how it’s done” but as an actual lesson. If something lands unexpectedly in the room, stay with it.

DEBRIEF (5 MIN)

Return to teacher mode. Ask three questions:

- What did you notice in yourself during the lesson?
- What questions did the lesson raise for you that you’d want answered before teaching it?
- What moment in the lesson do you think would land hardest for your students — and what would you do?

Take 2–3 responses per question. These responses are the curriculum’s best preparation. Write the unanswered questions on chart paper. Answer them now if you can. If you cannot, acknowledge them honestly: “That’s a real question. Here’s how I’d navigate it.”

5.2 · BLOCK 5 (30 MINUTES)

BLOCK 5

Teacher Reflection as Personal Practice

Facilitator purpose: The Teacher Reflection box is the most important structural element in this curriculum for teacher sustainability. Introduce it as a habit before Day 1, not as an afterthought.

INTRODUCE THE TEACHER REFLECTION BOX (5 MIN)

Every lesson in this curriculum contains a Teacher Reflection prompt. It is not a form to be submitted, a record to be reviewed, or an accountability measure of any kind. It is a private processing tool for you, the teacher, after each lesson. It exists for one reason: this curriculum will do real work in you as you deliver it. If you have nowhere to put that work, it accumulates. Teachers who neglect their own reflection in emotionally demanding curricula burn out faster and deliver less effectively over time. The reflection box is your drain.

Teachers of K–2 students carry an extra layer: young children’s distress is often pre-verbal, and teachers absorb that without language for it. The Reflection box matters even more here. Five minutes after each lesson is the difference between a sustainable practice and a teacher who runs out by November.

MODEL A REAL RESPONSE (10 MIN)

The facilitator shares their own Teacher Reflection response — written in advance, from a real experience with this material. Not a polished, professional response. A real one. This is non-negotiable. Teachers cannot be asked to be vulnerable in their reflection practice if the facilitator is not willing to model it. The facilitator should have completed a reflection from Block 4’s live lesson delivery before reading it aloud.

SAMPLE PROMPT

"What did this lesson surface for you personally? What are you still carrying from it?" Read your actual response. Sit with the silence after.

ESTABLISH THE HABIT (15 MIN)

Have each teacher write their first reflection now — from today's PD session.

REFLECTION PROMPT

"What from today do you most need to sit with before your first lesson? What do you already know about yourself that will help you deliver this curriculum? What do you not yet know?"

Allow 10 minutes of private writing. Do not collect. Do not ask for sharing. End with: "This is the habit. It takes 5 minutes after each lesson. It is the most important thing you can do to make sure you can keep delivering this curriculum at the level it deserves."

5.2 · BLOCK 6 (15 MINUTES)**BLOCK 6**

Glossary Orientation & Q&A

Facilitator purpose: Every staff member who interacts with students must use the same vocabulary. Shared language is the infrastructure of this curriculum. This block is short but non-negotiable.

WALK THROUGH THE GLOSSARY (8 MIN)

Distribute the participant one-pager (5.5 at the end of this section). The one-pager contains the twelve most essential vocabulary terms — drawn from Section 4.9 (Curriculum Vocabulary Glossary). Walk through each term: define it, give a classroom example, and if there is a common misuse or confusion, name it.

THREE TERMS THAT REQUIRE SPECIAL ATTENTION AT GRADES K-2

- "Oops" vs. "I Am Bad" — the K-2 frame for guilt vs. shame. Every staff member who interacts with these students should use this language consistently. "That was an Oops, not a forever" should be a recognizable phrase across the building.
- "Saying sorry and meaning it" — repair without self-punishment. Many children come from homes where saying sorry means being shamed. The curriculum reframes apology as a small act of repair, not a confession of badness.
- "Sammy says..." — when Sammy holds a hard moment, teachers should use the same opening when revisiting the content one-on-one. Sammy's authority in the room is real to children at this age.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FOUNDATION (K-2)

OPEN Q&A (7 MIN)

“What questions do you have that we haven’t answered today?” Take as many as time allows. Write unanswered questions on chart paper. Post them publicly. Tell teachers: “If a question came up today that you couldn’t resolve, it will come up in your classroom. That’s not a problem — it’s preparation. You now know to expect it.”

CLOSING WORDS

“You are ready. You don’t have to be perfect. You have to be present. Your students have been waiting for a classroom that holds them this way.”

5.3 Mid-Year Professional Development Session

Facilitator Guide · 90 Minutes · Deliver After Unit 2 Closes (December)

TOTAL TIME	90 minutes (3 blocks · no break required)
AUDIENCE	All classroom teachers delivering Architecture of Grace · The Foundation · Grades K–2. School counselors welcome. Administrators participate as learners.
FACILITATOR	Building principal, instructional coach, or counselor who delivered the initial half-day PD. Read full guide 24 hours in advance.
TIMING	Deliver within 2 weeks of Unit 2 closing (December). Must precede U3 L3.
MATERIALS	Chart paper · markers · teacher journals or index cards · printed participant reference card · timer visible to facilitator
PURPOSE	Debrief implementation, recalibrate the disclosure protocol, surface teacher wellbeing concerns, and prepare teachers emotionally for Unit 3.

TONE-SETTING NOTE

This session is not a compliance check. It is a structural support. Teachers who have spent a full semester carrying emotionally weighted curriculum deserve a room that holds them the way they have been holding their students. Set that tone from the opening.

5.3 · BLOCK 1 (30 MINUTES)

BLOCK 1

Implementation Debrief

Facilitator purpose: Teachers have been delivering this curriculum for a full semester. Before you give them anything new, let them say what has actually happened.

OPENING (5 MIN)

Ask teachers to write privately for 3 minutes (not shared):

OPENING PROMPT

"Think of one moment from the last semester of delivering this curriculum that stayed with you after class. Not the lesson plan — the moment. What happened? What did you carry home?"

STRUCTURED DEBRIEF (20 MIN)

Post four questions on chart paper. One at a time, 4–5 minutes each. Facilitator listens and captures themes without evaluating.

- What has been working better than you expected? What surprised you about how students responded?
- What has been harder than you expected? What lesson or moment did you feel under-prepared for?
- What questions do you still have that the initial PD didn't answer?
- What are 2–3 students you are still thinking about from Units 1–2?

CAUTION

Do not let the fourth question become a student-deficit conversation. Redirect: "What does this student need from you going into Unit 3?" The question is about teacher action, not student pathology.

CLOSING THE DEBRIEF (5 MIN)

Acknowledge the themes you heard without ranking them. Name anything that needs Block 2: "I heard several of you say disclosures happened differently than expected. We're going to spend the next block on exactly that."

5.3 · BLOCK 2 (35 MINUTES)

BLOCK 2

Disclosure Protocol Recalibration

Facilitator purpose: Teachers have now used the protocol in real conditions. This block connects it to what actually happened and prepares them for Unit 3's harder content.

PROTOCOL REVIEW FROM EXPERIENCE (15 MIN)

Distribute the participant reference card. Ask: "In the last semester, did anyone have a disclosure that required you to use this protocol? Which step was hardest in the moment?"

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FOUNDATION (K-2)

"I froze."	Normal. Step 1 is all you need: stop and move toward the student. Everything else follows from presence.
"I wasn't sure if it was Type 3 or 4."	When uncertain, treat as Type 4. Let the counselor assess. You are not required to assess accurately under pressure — you are required to act.
"The student said 'I'm fine' but I wasn't sure."	"I'm fine" after a significant disclosure is almost always protective. Follow up privately after class. Brief the counselor.
"Nothing came up for me."	Also valid. Some classrooms generate less activation. Unit 3 will change the frequency.

UNIT 3 PREPARATION — HIGH-RISK LESSONS (15 MIN)

U3 L3 · FORGIVING IS NOT THE SAME AS TRUSTING

Some students in every classroom are in ongoing unsafe situations. This lesson may be the first time they hear clearly that they do not have to return to harm. Counselor on-site is mandatory. Before delivering U3 L3, identify 2–3 students you are watching. Know who they are before you walk in. U2 L6 — When It's Hard to Forgive Yourself (★★ HIGHEST RISK) — also requires counselor-on-site protocol.

RE-PRACTICE: THE ONE SENTENCE THAT MATTERS (5 MIN)

Have teachers practice this sentence out loud with a partner — twice. It must be automatic under stress.

PRACTICE SENTENCE

"Thank you for trusting me with this. I want to make sure you have the right support — I'm going to walk you to [counselor's name] right now."

5.3 · BLOCK 3 (25 MINUTES)

BLOCK 3

Teacher Wellbeing & Entering Unit 3

Facilitator purpose: This is the most important block. Give teachers permission to care for themselves before Unit 3 begins. Name what the semester has cost them.

THE FACILITATOR'S OWN REFLECTION (10 MIN)

This block begins with the facilitator modeling, not instructing. Read aloud — from your actual Teacher Reflection notes, not a prepared script — something this semester surfaced for you personally in relation to this curriculum.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FOUNDATION (K-2)

NON-NEGOTIABLE

If you have not kept Teacher Reflection notes, you must write something genuine before this session. Teachers cannot be asked to be vulnerable if you are delivering this block from behind professional distance.

After your own reflection, give teachers 5 minutes to write privately:

PRIVATE REFLECTION PROMPT

"What has this curriculum surfaced in you personally that you have been carrying? What lesson hit closer to home than you expected? What have you been putting down after class that you haven't named to anyone?"

TEACHER SUPPORT WEB (10 MIN)

Ask teachers to map their own support web on an index card — drawing from the same activity students did in U2 L7 (or whichever unit's Wrap-Up addresses support).

- Who is on your support web right now?
- Have you actually used it this semester?
- Is there anything you've been carrying that you need to put down before Unit 3?

Before closing: "You taught your students that asking for support is wisdom, not weakness. The same is true for you. Identify one person on your support web you will contact before U3 L3 if you need to."

CLOSING WORDS

"Your students are carrying something from this semester into Unit 3. So are you. That is not a problem — that is what this curriculum does. Go in with your eyes open, your counselor on speed dial, and the knowledge that what you have built in this room over the last five months is already changing things. Unit 3 begins next week. You are ready."

5.4 Facilitator Slide Outline (Half-Day Module)

No design required. These headings translate directly to slides or chart paper. Add your school logo and colors as desired. The slide outline is calibrated to BOOK ONE — The Foundation (Grades K-2).

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FOUNDATION (K-2)

1	Welcome + Opening Reflection	Opening reflection prompt (see Block 1). Why we're here. What this day is not (a compliance training).
2	Shame vs. Guilt: The Research	Brown (2010), Tangney et al. (2007). Shame = "I am bad." Guilt = "I did bad." Different neural pathways. Different behavioral outcomes. Pair-share.
3	Self-Compassion: Not What You Think	Neff (2011). Three elements. Not self-esteem. Research outcomes. Name the resistance — then address it.
4	Forgiveness Education: The Evidence Base	Enright & Fitzgibbons. What forgiveness is not (reconciliation, condoning, forgetting). What it produces in the research. Why it is teachable.
5	Holding the K-2 Room: Productive Discomfort vs. Acute Distress	Three K-2 scenario exercise. What is each? What is your response? Debrief.
6	Your Own Material	Private journal prompt. Optional share. You don't need to be healed. You need to be aware.
7	The 6-Step Disclosure Protocol	Display all 6 steps. Walk through. Do not rush this slide.
8	Role-Play: K-2 Scenarios	Display scenario text. Pair practice. Full-group debrief. Key distinctions.
9	Live Lesson: U1 L5	Oops vs. I Am Bad delivered live. Close laptop. Be in the room.
10	Teacher Reflection: Your First Entry	Display the three reflection prompts. 10 minutes private writing. No collection. No share required. This is the habit.
11	Glossary Walk + Q&A	Refer to one-pager. 12 key terms. Special attention to the three identified for Grades K-2. Open Q&A. Chart unanswered questions.
12	Closing: You Are Ready	"You don't have to be perfect. You have to be present." Distribute one-pager. Send teachers off.

5.5 Participant One-Pager

This single page is the teacher's take-home reference from the PD day. It contains the essential vocabulary and the disclosure protocol in compact form. Print one per teacher (Grades K-2 edition). Laminate if possible.

12 ESSENTIAL VOCABULARY TERMS

Shame	"I am bad." Self-attack. Hides and harms.
Guilt	"I did something bad." Behavior-focused. Leads to repair.
Internal Critic	The shame voice. Attacks the person, not the behavior.
Compassionate Witness	The kind observer voice. Sees clearly without attacking.
Forgiveness	A gift to yourself. Not reconciliation. Not condoning. Not forgetting.
Grace Gap	Unearned kindness extended across a relational gap. A chosen act, not a reaction.
Self-Compassion	Treating yourself with the care you'd offer a good friend after a mistake.
Oops / Forever	Distinguishing a mistake (Oops) from a permanent identity statement (Forever).
Narrative Identity	The story a person tells about who they are, built from their experiences.
Charitable Interpretation	Choosing the most generous explanation for another's behavior.
Productive Discomfort	The learning edge. Sitting with a hard truth. Do not rescue students from it.
Community Charter	The class's year-end public commitment to grace practices. The culminating artifact.

IN-THE-MOMENT DISCLOSURE PROTOCOL (6 STEPS)

1. Pause. Move toward the student. Give class independent work.
2. "I can see something is happening. You don't have to explain it."
3. Offer a choice: hall or stay and breathe. Both are valid.
4. Listen. Assess: Type 1-3 (contained) or Type 4 (safety concern)?
5. Type 4: "Thank you for trusting me. I'm walking you to [counselor] now." Do not promise confidentiality. Do not delay.
6. Document. Debrief with counselor or colleague. Put it down before your next class.

TEACHER REFLECTION HABIT

After every lesson: 5 minutes. Private. Not collected. Answer one of: What surfaced for me today? What did I want to rush past — and why? What do I want to carry forward?

CLOSING WORDS

"You don't need to be perfectly healed to teach this curriculum. You need to be present and aware. Your students have been waiting for a classroom that holds them this way." **Architecture of Grace · The Foundation · School of Life Foundation · James Anthony Ramsden**

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